



THE SCORCHING EROTIC MURDER MYSTERY

A
KILLER
OF A
ONE NIGHT STAND

EPISODE SIX

BESTSELLING INDIE EROTICA AUTHOR

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About the Author

Max Sebastian has written more than 20 novels, and regularly tops the bestseller lists for steamy erotic fiction. He began writing erotica at Literotica.com nearly two decades ago, and broke into the wider world of publishing in 2011.

Since then, Max has become well-known for sensual, steamy adventures in which couples explore thrilling alternatives to monogamous relationships, on their way to a very raunchy happy ever after—including menage stories, wife-sharing, hotwives, cuckolding and partner-swapping in various forms.

Max lives in London, England, and loves to hear from readers. Visit his website at www.maxsebastian.net.

Some of Max's Other Books

Web: MaxSebastian.net

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Out of His League (with Kenny Wright).

Rock Her World

The One That I Married

Game Changer

Obsessive Trilogy.

Marriage 2.0

A Lockdown Affair

A Killer of a One Night Stand

Episode Six

Max Sebastian

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One

Jonah Fielding had been annoyed at Detective Inspector Mulray as he spoke to her on the phone, demanding to know where his currently estranged girlfriend Emma was planning on being that evening. He might almost have said he was angry at her, except that there had been some blessed relief that she was able to at least tell him where and when the so-called “Breeding Party” was being held.

“Hey it’s not my fault you got her interested in this whole Network thing,” Mulray had said as he called her.

“But you have to concede how it looks from my angle,” he said, pacing up and down along the wall-to-ceiling windows of his dead brother’s apartment.

“How does it look?”

“She’s supposed to be helping me in my attempts to track down my brother’s killer. But now she intends on infiltrating the Network and its big annual event—like some kind of amateur spy, for God’s sake—and I’m not allowed to know what she’s doing. She has you to monitor her progress with those ludicrous camera-glasses of hers.”

“Ludicrous? Seem pretty useful to me,” the detective said, seeming completely calm in the face of Jonah’s annoyance.

“Well okay, so they have their uses. But all the same. It seems to me that you basically have her working for you. And she’s only a student, for Heaven’s sake. Not exactly a professional undercover officer. Don’t you have some of those to spare, by the way?”

Mulray chuckled, “You know what? I’m fresh out right now.”

“I just don’t think it’s right. You’re basically relying on a young woman going in there and offering herself up on a platter to any young guy who wants to... well, take her.”

“And if you were going in there with her, pretending she was your wife, you wouldn’t be offering her up on a platter to any young guy, just so you might get closer to a murderer—who let’s face it, may not even be there tonight?”

Jonah sighed. She did have a point.

“At least I’d be there to watch out for her.”

“I’m going to be there to do that, you don’t have to worry.”

“I’m not talking about hovering somewhere outside the party balancing an iPad on my lap,” he said. “Right there, watching.”

Mulray laughed, “You’re just upset because you don’t get to see your hot little girlfriend getting a right royal seeing to!”

“I...” he hesitated, unable to deny the fact that the idea of his beloved Emma wondering around a huge party with the complete freedom to enjoy the sexual attentions of anyone she might take a fancy to did appeal to him, massively. He could well have been psychologically messed up by this whole investigation, but he couldn’t deny that this was now his biggest sexual turn-on: loving a beautiful blonde who was entirely free to indulge in her insatiable desire for sex of many different flavors.

“Don’t worry, your secret’s safe with me,” the detective said. “Although it’s amusing how much Lily Foster’s rubbed off on you.”

“Look,” he seethed. “All that’s beside the point. The point now is that you’re going to tell me exactly where this Breeding Party thing is being held tonight, and when it’s supposed to all kick off.”

“Oh, I am, am I?” Mulray said dryly.

“Yes, that’s exactly what you’ll do.”

“Or else?”

“Or else...”



An hour later, he emerged from the apartment building at West India Quay to find Mulray's unmarked police car parked outside the building, ignoring the pedestrianized nature of the dockside just over the water from London's Canary Wharf business area.

He smiled to himself, and wandered over to the passenger door of the dark blue Ford Focus. She'd become his own personal taxi service over the past weeks.

Opening the door, climbing into the vehicle, here was another reason why any anger he felt toward her simply melted away: she looked sensational, tonight more than ever. She'd foregone her usual suit for what appeared to be work out gear: a black Adidas top, a pair of skin-tight black leggings that showed off her legs and left much of her calves bare, and a pair of pink and white running shoes. Slotting into the passenger seat beside her, breathing in the cinnamon aroma of her usual sweet perfume, he was reminded of the little crush he had on her, despite his love for Emma.

"You didn't have to threaten me," she said, pouting at him as he buckled up and they slowly pulled away from Number 1, West India Quay.

"I'm sorry, I had to be sure."

"I thought you didn't like that reporter, anyway? Why would you sell me out to him?"

"He has his uses."

"I was even thinking about inviting you along anyway," she gave him a sly smile that reminded him that Detective Inspector Mulray liked to mess with his relationships, even if she wasn't going to ever make the moves on him herself.

"So where is it being held?" he asked her as she edged the car away from his apartment building and along the pedestrianized dock, toward the

road. Then he added, “And what happened to your suit? Did I drag you out of the gym or something?”

Referring to her appearance seemed to give him the justification to glance over at her, snatching another eyeful of her alluring outfit. That was, until she flicked her eyes left to catch him in the act and silently admonish him.

“It’s at a big new hotel down on the riverbank by Richmond,” she said. “And if it’s any of your business, I’m attempting to go incognito, in case anyone’s wondering why I’m lurking around the hotel.”

“Let me guess, you’re the chic young wealthy hotel resident out for an evening run?”

“Something like that.”

It was getting on for seven in the evening, and Jonah was just relieved that an afternoon of leaving messages for the Detective had come up trumps. Emma hadn’t responded to any of his voicemail pleadings after she’d left him there on the curbside outside the little hotel in Soho, Hazlitt’s. The idea had come to him as he’d taken a frustrating Tube ride back to Canary Wharf and home, that judging from what he knew about Emma’s curious new friendship with Detective Mulray, she might know where Emma was going to be that night.

Now they were driving westwards through Limehouse and towards Central London when Jonah’s mobile buzzed insistently.

It was Keeley. Jonah groaned. He’d been planning to go with the Guardian reporter that night, to sneak into Lady Moss’s house in an attempt to find the photographs of past Network events on her desktop computer in the study. They knew Lady Moss would be attending the Network’s Breeding Party, and that she would be safely out of the way for their little breaking and entering effort—but now that Emma was going to the Breeding Party, there was no way Jonah could be anywhere else.

He touched the button to accept the call.

“Where are you?” came Keeley’s hushed voice. Jonah could imagine he was not too far from Lady Moss’s house just then, and not in a position to speak normally. “I thought we were doing this?”

Jonah sighed. “Something came up. I’ve got to try and get into that Network event.”

“The Breeding Party?”

“My... my friend is sneaking her way in there.”

“Jesus. Hope your friend knows what she’s getting herself into.”

“Well, that’s one reason I need to be there, and maybe get myself in if it’s possible.”

Keeley coughed, then said: “Look, I’ve got my buddy the IT genius on the other line—probably easier for me to get in and out of the house alone anyway.”

“Yes, of course. We’ve still got to get at those pictures.”

“But if you see Lady Moss at that event, and she looks like she’s leaving... perhaps you’ll give me the heads up.”

“Will do.”

“I’m switching my phone to silent—it’ll be text only comms from now on. I won’t answer any calls.”

Jonah said, “But isn’t the house empty right now? Lady Moss and her valet will be at the party. He takes pictures at those events, doesn’t he?”

Keeley said, “The nanny’s in there—with Christopher, the Moss boy. She’s distracted, completely absorbed by the kid, so I’ll be able to get by her. But I can’t take any risks.”

“No. Okay. Best of luck.”

Mulray looked over at him as he hung up the mobile phone. “Do I need to ask what all that’s about?” she said like some disapproving schoolteacher.

“It’s... well, bending the rules a little.”

The detective rolled her eyes.

“That’s part of the attraction of getting in a little outside help, isn’t it?” Jonah grinned. “I mean, we take all responsibility here. And tonight, my reporter friend takes responsibility.”

“I suppose if he gets caught, it won’t raise too many eyebrows these days, a newspaper journalist violating somebody’s privacy,” she said, but sighed. “It’s important, what you’re doing?”

Jonah nodded. “We think so. Lady Moss’s butler or servant, or whatever he is—he takes pictures at these annual Network events. Maybe others, too. But it’s possible there might be something useful in them—you know, images showing who might have hung out with some of the murder victims at these events. You never know, might dredge up some useful suspects.”

Another sigh from the detective, but he could see in her face that at this stage, any kind of a lead in this case would be welcome.

Two

It was surprising how green and leafy it was there in Richmond, a London borough, but as Mulray drove them down a country-esque lane towards the Seldorne Hotel and Retreat, the extensive grounds and air of isolation from the bustle of the big city actually leant Jonah a touch of confidence that it might be possible to slip into the place, and check on Emma's progress at the party.

They had to pull off the road a few times, and switch off all lights, when they saw large luxurious vehicles—supercars, limousines, blinged-up SUVs—bringing the wealthy and the influential to the big party. Mulray's Ford seemed a little out of place for this kind of gathering, but none of the party guests stopped to raise concern about the apparently empty vehicle parked up on the side of the lane approaching the great mansion house that had been converted to a hotel and resort.

At last, they came close enough to the main gates of the hotel grounds, and Mulray found a nice shady spot where she could leave the car almost out of sight.

“So what's your plan, Sherlock?” she said as she shut off the engine.

“I'm not sure. I guess I'll scope out the grounds a bit, see if I can't get close to the building and the party without being spotted.”

The detective nodded. “You think you'll get in?”

He shrugged. They saw a small group of people walking into the grounds of the hotel, from God knew where, but perhaps they lived locally. They were all wearing smart evening wear—dinner jackets, cocktail dresses. Jonah groaned silently—he should have known to bring a suit. His dark attire might be appropriate for skulking around the grounds of the house as the sun went down, but it would be no good if he found a way in, and actually wanted to infiltrate the party.

Getting out of the vehicle, Mulray was putting on a pair of headphones, connected to an iPhone mounted on a small arm band on her bicep. She looked very much the late-night runner preparing for a jog around the leafy neighborhood.

“You’re not taking the iPad with you?” he asked her, puzzled as to why she would come all this way and not want to oversee what Emma was getting up to at the party.

Mulray smiled, and tapped the iPhone. “Better technology,” she said. “Now, I’m more mobile.”

Jonah nodded. Perhaps Mulray had access to some better kit via Scotland Yard, compared to Emma’s attempts to find spy equipment on eBay or wherever else on the Internet she’d looked.

“Let me know where she is when you link up with her?” he asked Mulray.

“I’ll text you.”



Alone, Jonah made his way around the edge of the property. It was certainly a big place, with extensive grounds, and as he ventured closer and closer to the river, his optimism grew that it might be possible to scale these high stone walls if he had to.

His progress was slowed by his constant need to check for any kind of security cameras. The problem was more that he didn’t see any—yet felt certain that they must be out there.

Again, as he came closer and closer to the riverbank, he began to grow more optimistic. This might be an unusual event, but at the end of the day this was only a hotel. It was outside of the centre of London, in leafy Richmond—maybe it just didn’t need the kind of intense security you

might expect in the middle of a big city. Or else its security was focused on the building itself, not so much the perimeter of the grounds.

Reaching the river, he found that the high wall came to an end. The Thames Path ran along the riverbank, a public path, and the hotel itself seemed to have the dilemma that it had to allow the public past on that path, but didn't want to obscure the view from its guests—and that left the property open to the likes of Jonah Fielding.

There was plenty of foliage around here to conceal him as he peered around the wall at the extensive lawn, and the blazing lights of the house itself, which looked large enough to be a castle. From here, he could see the party was large enough that guests were spilling out onto the terrace in front of the house, and onto the wide lawn which stretched down to the Thames.

As he paused, he fished out his phone to check for messages. Nothing from Mulray about finding Emma—but there were a couple of updates from Keeley.

One:

>I'm in. Nanny's no trouble at all, playing with the kid like she's his mother, totally besotted. Easy to get past.

Then the next one:

>My friend's helped me get into the Moss's computer. Knew he wouldn't let me down. Pictures are here—seems like a lot of them to go through, though. Gonna be a long night.

Jonah could picture sitting in that huge house in Chiswick with its high ceilings, scrolling through hundreds of photographs looking for a needle in a haystack, all the while feeling the risk of discovery. He wasn't exactly distraught that he'd avoided that particular task himself.

Here at the Seldorne Hotel, however, Jonah really did wish he'd worn a tuxedo—there were so many random people just milling about on the grass in front of the building and its river-facing terrace, smoking or chatting or admiring the view in the fading light, that he held certain he could have just drifted in from where he was, and no one would have

taken him for anything other than just another guest. If only he could strip off his outer clothes and have a dinner jacket underneath, like James Bond.

Nevertheless, keeping to the shady cover of the bushes and the trees, he could move closer to the house, and the terrace out front. The sound of classical music and the murmur of people grew as he neared the house. It was a huge place, and the growing darkness and his black clothing was in Jonah's favor. He could get right up to the low wall separating the terrace from the rest of the grounds, and work his way along it without alerting any of the few guests milling about in the grounds to his presence. He kept back from the central steps leading down from the terrace onto the lawn, however.

He peered over the wall, then froze as he saw a woman in high heels and a tiny cream dress standing nearby, swigging Champagne straight from a £500 bottle while swaying to the music emanating from inside the house. After a few moments, he was confident she wasn't going to see him.

There were plenty of people out on the terrace, but from where he was crouching, he could see through a row of white-painted arches to a huge banqueting hall stuffed with even more smartly-dressed partygoers. Jesus—these were all members of the Network? It impressed him, but also prompted a sinking feeling in his stomach—with all these people, how would he spot Emma?

It took a moment for Jonah to get his head around this party. Initially, he looked and saw only a sea of men in tuxedos and women in smart cocktail dresses, sipping Champagne and acting as anyone would at a formal soiree. Only as he watched did the reality begin to emerge. He noticed a few women here and there embracing men who had removed their dinner jackets. Kissing—and not just polite pecks on the cheeks. People around them were watching, chatting and laughing and smiling as they did so as though it was the most perfectly normal thing in the world to happen at a grand dinner party.

Now he saw through the people various other men who were wearing simply black pants, white shirt and black bow tie—no jacket—were also in the process of flirting with women, or were engaging in the initial stirrings of passion. The white shirts helped Jonah to recognize where things were going on.

Jesus—over there on the other side of the terrace, a forty-something woman was crouching in front of a thirty-something jacket-free man, and the bobbing motion of her head made it clear what she was doing with him—right out in the open, where dozens of other people could see.

He turned his head to look along the outer wall of the terrace, to see some fifty yards or so away a blonde woman in her late thirties perched on the wall itself, a man on his knees in front of her, his head buried between her thighs. Among the cluster of partygoers hovering over them, observing intently while they swirled their Champagne flutes, he even thought he could pick out the woman's husband.

This whole thing was one enormous gathering of the kind of voyeuristic wife-sharing events that had marked Network evenings as so different from other one night stands Jonah had been on arranged through the No Strings website.

Buzzing all over, Jonah contemplated the fact that Emma might be here somewhere, and if she was undercover, she might well have already found a jacket-less man to play with.

He watched for a while, his eyes flicking between the various clusters of people, observing the displays that were visible to him, and trying to see what was going on within the groups of guests whom he could not penetrate. All the time, he was trying to think of some way to get in there, to get hold of a white shirt, a proper suit, a bow tie. If he'd been James Bond—and assuming as Bond he didn't have evening wear constantly on underneath his outer clothes—he'd probably just walk up to some semi-drunk henchman and off him on the head, then steal his clothes.

He did manage to edge along the wall, crouching to keep out of sight, in order to scope out the terrace. He even managed to cross the central stairway without being seen, and came to within just ten feet of the woman sitting on the terrace wall. The people watching her were so focused on her, as her young man now stood, and dropped his pants to present his large erection for her oral enjoyment, that they didn't spot Jonah skipping past below the wall.

This was the less busy side of the terrace, and he did begin to wonder whether he might be tempted to play the action hero if a particularly

inebriated man wandered by. But no matter how focussed on the shared wives guests were, there were simply too many people around to risk hopping over the wall and laying somebody out to snatch his clothes.

Perhaps he had to fall back, go find Mulray, see if she'd managed to connect with the signal from Emma's spy camera, but had forgotten to text him about it.

Then just as he was coming round to making a decision to do exactly that, something stopped him stone dead: a familiar face.

Lily Foster.

Jonah's eyes widened.

There she was in a stylish little black dress, emphasis on the 'little', casually sauntering through the people on the terrace, down to cast her eyes over the view of the darkened Thames and the lights of the city beyond. It took Jonah's breath away that she might be a member of the Network, and make no mention of it when they'd talked so much about her adventures in marital infidelity.

Well, he'd never directly asked her about the Network—he'd never thought to. But also, if this was some kind of secret society, there might be pressure on Lily to keep her membership to herself, no matter if she was openly discussing details of her own open or semi-open relationship.

It shook Jonah's trust, somehow, to know this disturbingly new aspect to her life. But he wasn't to have much time to dwell on it. He saw Lily turn her head back toward the house, as though hearing something, and now he received a powerful jolt to the chest to watch the familiar form of Emma emerge to join Lily out on the edge of the terrace.

Jonah's phone buzzed in his pocket. Mulray, with a message that now seemed less than useful.

>Found her. Looks like she's making her way out onto the terrace on the river side of the main building.

Thanks, he said silently to himself. Yet if he hadn't been here already, he would have been appreciative of Mulray keeping her promise to let him

know.

Emma looked sensational in a scarlet satin dress that clung to her body like a second skin. And she walked arm-in-arm with a man who was not wearing a jacket.

Jonah felt the acid burn of jealousy over the thirty-something man accompanying her. He had short, dark hair and a confident bearing about his broad shoulders. Was she going to do something with him, in front of other people? Or had she brought him for Lily? Feeling his manhood thickening at the thought of his Emma being so wicked as to fool around with another man in public, Jonah couldn't quite decide which option he preferred.

God, but Emma hung off the man's shoulder as though they were a couple, as though she'd already done something with him.

Lily showed no surprise to see Emma there. And Emma seemed to bear none of the ill-will toward the older brunette that Jonah had assumed she had. She'd pretty much forbidden him to see Lily, such had been her jealousy—and their big falling out had been because she thought Lily had been in his bed again. Yet here they were, best buddies. Laughing and drinking and prodding the strong hunk of a man standing quietly ready to do as they wanted. How had they become so friendly?

Emma kissed the man, and Jonah felt his heart jump—but his cock swell. Watching her with someone else had the strangest effect on Jonah, it made him feel almost high. She was so beautiful, and obviously having such fun. Sure, there was the fear of losing her, but he could repress those feelings. Had to, if he was going to cope with this.

But then Emma's man stepped back, and Lily was turning fully to her now, approaching her. Jonah tried to interpret their expressions to one another. Were they partnering up for some kind of undercover mission? Circulating the party, trying to tease out clues as to some of the City types partying around them?

Emma put her hand around Lily's neck and pulled her in—for a dance?

For a kiss.

Jonah stifled a loud gasp as he watched the two beautiful women touch lips. The older brunette was gently placing her hands up on Emma's shoulders, smiling tenderly as she sucked on her bottom lip.

The two of them twirled slowly around, hands in each others' hair as they kissed on and on, their tongues slipping into each others' mouths, lips closing around lips. Was this for show? It looked too good to be faked. Too genuinely affectionate.

There were a few people now turning to see what was going on. They were the only same-sex couple on the terrace, after all. But then Emma's dark-haired man stepped forward again, and Lily made way for him to take up where she left off with the young blonde.

Watching her kissing the man made Jonah feel so very different than he had seeing her kissing Lily. There had been none of the jealousy watching the two women. With Emma being bisexual, in reality there should be just as much chance of Jonah losing her to a woman as to a man, and yet there was just no physical trace of fear watching her with Lily in the way there now was seeing her with another man.

Jonah was surprised Emma was being so public. She'd been something of a party animal when he first met her, and yet this seemed so much more extreme than he'd thought she'd be capable of. More and more, the party seemed to be spilling out onto the terrace, and a growing cluster of party-goers was now there watching Emma with her new lover.

The man turned her, so that they were both facing the river, Emma's back to him. Then he roughly shoved down the front of her dress, shocking Jonah with the sight of her bare breasts exposed before so many people, before the man grabbed her, covering those hard pink nipples with his strong hands.

Jonah resisted the temptation to leap into action to defend her—she wanted this. Emma was smiling, standing there without objecting to her exposure as he unzipped her dress and then peeled it down her waist, and over her hips, leaving her in a pair of black lace panties and high heels.

He ducked down behind her, grabbed her buttocks in both hands, squeezed her, pushed his face into her as she leaned over the terrace wall.

From where Jonah was, he could hear Emma's moans as the man ate her from behind. Jonah was so hard watching her. She was clearly enjoying herself, clearly having fun. And that was what he wanted for her, wasn't it? And it was so hot to see her being so wicked.

The dark-haired man dragged her panties down her thighs, and she stepped out of them. She did look stunning bending over the wall, naked but for her high-heeled shoes. Jonah felt so conflicted as he watched the man kiss his way up one of her thighs, and then stand behind her to press his bare cock up against her.

She groaned, and he was inside her, holding her hips as he thrust into her, her body rocking from his motion. There was a small peel of applause from the people behind as the man entered her—perhaps for the first actual penetration there on the terrace that evening.

Click.

Jonah heard the camera and saw its flash before spotting Reynolds lurking there among the crowd, capturing Emma's public display for posterity, though whose posterity was unclear. He felt a sudden jab in his chest, that Emma's attempt to go undercover might be photographed and perhaps, some day, leaked onto the Internet. Even if Reynolds was under any kind of Network controls regarding the distribution of his photographs, there was enough chance that hackers could one day get hold of these images.

Maybe he'd have to organize another break-in at Lady Moss's house, to find and destroy the images from tonight. In the mean time, there was nothing he could do to stop Reynolds firing off shot after shot of Emma as she cried out, a stranger thrusting into her from behind.

Jonah felt such a powerful wave of emotion to watch her with him, despite the fact that he'd already watched her being taken by another man—Clement. It didn't seem to last long before the man was pumping into her, releasing his load deep inside her, the mob cheering him on as he came. Well, this was a breeding party. Was Emma playing by the rules, and risking pregnancy? It made Jonah shudder.

“Quite a show.”

Jonah was startled to find a blonde woman sitting on the edge of the terrace wall, just yards away from where he was hiding, taking a long drag on a cigarette.

It was Lady Moss.

Three

Of course—if Reynolds was here at the event with a camera, Lady Moss would not be far away.

But how had he failed to notice her approaching? His focus had been completely distracted. She was wearing a white dress that was longer than a lot of the wives around the terrace, but was cut so much more finely than most, Jonah thought she resembled Grace Kelly in her prime.

“Well you already knew I was on the circuit, right? I could see you did when you visited,” she smiled, referring back to his visit to her house in Chiswick in the company of Detective Mulray. “You were just keeping it to yourself.”

“I guess I was.”

“Your detective friend around here somewhere?”

“Just me.” Jonah tried to act calm, the kind of Philip Marlowe approach to being busted by a potential femme fatale. He stood up, straight, out in the open. Well, he was busted anyway.

“And without an invitation,” she nodded, her eyes flicking over his black outfit, his total lack of evening wear. “So you’re still asking questions about those killings? You imagine someone here might know something about them?”

“I know about the Network,” he said. “I know that in some way, all of the murder victims were linked to it.”

Lady Moss breathed out another plume of smoke. She appeared calm. “Interesting,” she said after a pause. “But I dare say lots of people from the City are involved with the Network—and my husband’s killer did seem to target this particular sector, didn’t she?”

Jonah nodded his head toward Lily and Emma. The blonde had put her dress back on, and was standing there with Lily now, tenderly brushing the brunette's hair behind an ear and out of her face, before tilting her head to press her mouth to hers.

"You know who that is?" he asked Lady Moss, signaling Lily with a nod of his head. "The brunette?"

"She seems... vaguely familiar."

"Lily Foster. She's the wife of—"

"Julian Foster, yes. I remember now. I've seen her face in the papers."

"Her husband had no links to the financial sector. And she's here."

Lady Moss gave another nod, and patted the edge of the terra cotta tile beside her, inviting him to sit with her. "And so you've been watching her, is that it? And here she is, attending a lavish event thrown by a secret society... and here I turn up."

"So you do."

"So does that make us suspects?" she asked, then gave a wry smile.

"How very exciting. So does... Lily Foster... know you're here, watching us all?"

"I don't think so," he said, his hesitation lingering before he perched next to Lady Moss on the wall, figuring that if someone challenged him for being there, she might back him up somehow.

"Looks as though she's having fun with that pretty blonde."

"Uh-huh."

As they watched Emma and Lily kissing, they saw the older woman draw the straps of Emma's tight dress down over her shoulders, to reveal her bare breasts again. Emma ran her hand delicately up Lily's stomach, to explore her chest as she herself was fondled.

"Will that go in your report... or whatever you pass on to the police?"

“Not unless it’s relevant. I don’t have to say you’re here, either. But I need to know more about this... this Network.”

Lady Moss laughed, “Oh, none of this is illegal, you understand. It’s not something one wants the press to discover, of course...”

“Of course.”

Emma slipped the strap of Lily’s dress off over her shoulder, and then the other, to expose her stunning breasts, her large brownish nipples hard as pebbles. She ducked her head to take them one by one in her mouth, the brunette softly stroking her shoulder as she did so.

“Do you really think this... whole thing... has anything to do with those murders?”

Lady Moss tapped her cigarette out on the tile beside her. She looked a little healthier than he remembered from their first meeting at her home. Perhaps make-up helped—she’d put some effort into her appearance this evening. Her white dress clung to her curves, her golden hair flowed down her back like a waterfall.

“It’s possible. It’s too much of a coincidence, the links to the victims.”

“I hadn’t thought that our... social lives... might have led to poor Douglas meeting his end...”

She stared out over the Thames, her blue eyes sombre, even regretful.

“Well,” she smiled, trying not to cry, “all this is just a bit of fun, isn’t it? When you’re married, and you have no worries about money, you can just let your hair down sometimes, can’t you?”

“Sure you can,” Jonah said.

She smiled, “I mean, at first, it was all somewhat surprising, I’ll admit. To learn that Douglas had this strange... compulsion... to watch me... you know. With other men.”

Jonah nodded. But he understood Lord Moss’s compulsion now. And seeing Lady Moss in such elegant, gorgeous form, he could understand why he might want to watch her performing sexually.

“But a wife must understand her husband to love him, don’t you think?” she rubbed her eyes with a forefinger. “And of course, he could have had far worse vices than this, right? Drugs... prostitution... I don’t know, little boys... plenty of that going on in the establishment, isn’t there?”

“Certainly is.”

She sniffed. “Douglas just loved me. He wanted to show me off, and he wanted to watch me having the time of my life, indulging in my full sexuality.”

Jonah turned to find that Lily was now sitting on the wall, Emma kneeling on the floor between her legs, pushing up her dress as she kissed up her thighs. The number of onlookers watching the show had swollen again, almost to the point where they were encroaching on Jonah’s and Lady Moss’s view.

“You still come to many of these parties?” he asked Lady Moss.

“They take my mind off things. I know these people will be discreet, and sometimes I can let myself go. And if I’m going to continue seeing people through the Network... well, attending the big annual event is a must.”

“So your dealing with the Network—it’s not just this event, is it? You’re still arranging dates through that website your husband invested in? No Strings?”

Lady Moss turned to look him in the eye, and she did a poor job at concealing her surprise at his knowledge. “You have done your homework,” she said, then emitted a quiet sigh. “Sometimes I get a little... lonely. It’s nice to think that I can have some fun for an evening or two, no questions asked.”

Jonah was finding it difficult to concentrate on questioning Lady Moss. Emma was peeling Lily’s panties slowly down her thighs, and though he couldn’t quite see it with Lily’s thigh in the way, it was fairly obvious she was doing more than just a careful visual inspection of the brunette’s intimate area.

“I don’t think anyone would blame you for it,” he said. “I guess this whole thing tonight shows us how many women there are... how many married women there are looking for a little of the same thing from time to time. And just because your husband passed away...”

Lady Moss smiled again, and looked at Jonah a little differently. “You’ve done more than just asked someone about all this before, haven’t you?” she said. “You’ve been using that website yourself, haven’t you? What, were you pretending to be a trader, too?”

“Well, I...”

The beautiful blonde put her hand over her mouth, laughing with surprise. “You are clever. But how did you get through the vetting process?”

“Vetting process?”

“Oh, you must realize the Network will carry out certain... checks. To make sure you are who you say you are.”

“I didn’t do anything particularly special,” he said, feeling a coldness, a doubt, about how he might have got past a vetting process. Had the men following him been part of that? And if so, how had he survived, how had he been vetted?

“You go by a different name when you’re using the website?”

Jonah sighed. There seemed little point in hiding anything from her, now it was out there. “Robert. I used the name Robert.”

Lady Moss nodded, the corners of her mouth curling into a knowing smile. “Well, well, well,” she said. “So you’re Robert, huh? I’ll bet you’re the same Robert who’s been causing quite a stir among some of the women in the Network.”

He felt a certain pride in what she said, but his gaze was drawn back across the terrace to Emma, who had gathered quite a crowd by now, as she did to Lily something he could never have expected in a million years. Lily was lying back along the wide tiles topping off the wall, holding Emma’s head there, her own beautiful chest bare and heaving as

she breathed deeply, apparently uncaring as to how many people were watching.

“You know, someone here is going to see you pretty soon... Robert.” Lady Moss suddenly put her hands under her thighs, lifted her legs and swung them around with the grace of a former gymnast, so that she faced the river—and Jonah. “Maybe you should find a hiding place,” she added. “I can get Reynolds to dig you out a suit.”

Jonah glanced sideways, to the shade of the bushes, then felt a touch foolish as Lady Moss parted her thighs and lifted one foot onto the wall beside her, revealing the hiding place she’d had in mind for him.

She wasn’t wearing any underwear beneath that white dress of hers.

“And he’d happen to have a suit in my size available?” he said, edging toward her, eyes shifting to check that no one had yet noticed his unauthorized presence there, while confirming that Emma was still safely tied up with Lily.

“Reynolds is near enough,” she said.

He breathed in her expensive perfume as he arrived in front of her, and his hardness throbbed at the sight of her bare pussy, topped by a small triangle of golden down. He remembered watching her with her manservant. He remembered envying Reynolds. And now Lady Moss was sitting here, offering herself to him.

“Down, boy,” she said. “Unless you want to get kicked out of here.”

“You’ll call your... you’ll call Reynolds?”

She smiled. “No mobile phones allowed at this event. But he’ll be along soon. Especially if he sees that I’m having fun.”

Jonah stooped, getting an eyeful of her cleavage as he slung his arms under her thighs, hands moving to her behind, pulling her toward him on the edge of the wall. Well, Emma was still occupied with Lily, and he did have a responsibility to do what he could to get into the event—to infiltrate.

Besides, getting closer to Lady Moss could prove useful for the investigation.

He sank to his knees, face nudging in between her thighs, inhaling the musky aroma of her sex before touching his lips to it, his tongue slipping into her wetness to sample her tangy wetness. Lady Moss groaned as he touched her there, as he sucked gently on her clit and pressed his mouth to her, his nose tickled by the soft hairs on her mound.

She put her legs down as he continued to lick her, though she kept her thighs parted wide enough to grant him access, and the way she leaned back and held her cigarette in one hand might make it look to anyone on the terrace behind that she was simply sitting there on the wall, taking in the view, catching up on her nicotine dosage. It meant that if he craned his neck occasionally, he could just about see across to what Emma and Lily were doing.

Jonah kissed the apex of her sex, then eased a finger inside her slick pussy, making the blonde quietly catch her breath.

“Oh my...” she whispered as he parted her pussy lips with his fingers, and now drove his tongue as far inside her as he could reach.

Lady Moss placed her hands on Jonah’s head, pushing him gently but firmly against her wet pussy.

Again, Jonah could hear the click of the camera before spotting the dark-haired servant leaning over the terrace wall, capturing what was going on with his employer.

Lady Moss relaxed her grip on Jonah’s head, and beckoned to her servant. “I want you to find my new friend a suit, Reynolds,” she said quietly.

“Of course, my Lady,” the man replied without a hint of judgment. “I was going to suggest it myself.”

“Oh, and Reynolds...” Lady Moss turned, twisting her body to catch her man before he scurried away.

“Yes, my Lady?”

“Find out who that blonde is over there, would you?” Jonah felt his chest flutter as Lady Moss referred to Emma. “I think we should be introduced.”

Lady Moss turned completely around now, dropping down so that she could stand on the grass in front of Jonah, leaning over the terrace wall to rest on her elbows.

Jonah stood beside her at the terrace wall, both of them watching Lily lying along the wall on the other side of the terrace, her body writhing as Emma clearly made her come.

“Are you still hiding, Mr Fielding? Robert?” Lady Moss said.

Jonah dropped into a crouch behind her as she subtly edged up her dress to reveal the tempting roundness of her buttocks, and moved her feet further apart. Lady Moss laughed at her little joke, but then gasped as Jonah tilted his head upwards and moved in on her wet pussy once again.

By the time he came up for air again, Lady Moss was shaking and juddering in her own breathless orgasm, and Reynolds had returned bearing a suit together with a regulation white shirt and bow tie.

“You’ll have to change right here,” she told him, turning to help remove his clothes.

Pulling off his clothes, using Reynolds and Lady Moss as a shield, Jonah noticed that Emma and Lily had now gone. He couldn’t do much about it now he was with Lady Moss, but he felt slightly better about Emma’s safety if she was in Lily’s company.

The shirt went on first, but as he was pulling on the black suit pants, Lady Moss stole an opportunity to spread a hand over his package, purring, “Mmm... I’m going to have to lay claim to that later, Robert.”

The way she emphasized his pseudonym hinted at some kind of bargain, that she would keep his identity safe in the Network, in return for taking whatever she wanted from him. He didn’t mind so much—not if it meant he could use Lady Moss to get into the event.

“You know, when I was single, it all seemed like so much bother—sex,” she said, caressing his hardness through his pants. “Men were a crushing disappointment. But after I got married, I did miss it.”

Jonah asked, “Was it you or your husband who first suggested seeing other men?”

Lady Moss smiled. “Him, actually. Often is, you know, the husband.”

“Right.”

“I was surprised, but he proved well enough it turned him on.”

Reynolds handed Jonah a real bow tie, which he did not know how to tie, despite his years at Oxford. The butler nodded, and stepped behind him to tie it for him.

Jonah asked, “So those rumors about your husband...”

“Rumors?” she looked slightly startled for a fraction of a second, then relaxed and regained her cool.

“The police are under the impression... that he was impotent.”

“Oh no,” she grinned. “Douglas was never biologically impotent. He just... well... let’s just say some men who share their wives... go a little further with the fantasy than others...”

Jonah looked up, “So you’re saying he was... voluntarily impotent?”

She laughed, “I’m not sure I’d use that word. It started with him wanting me to... well, take control of him.”

“Sexually.”

She nodded. “We had a little... device... I locked him up while I was out for the evening with another man. He was unable to distract himself while he waited for me.”

“So you and he... you did...”

Lady Moss smiled. “We had a long hiatus, you might say. But toward the end... before he died... well, his interest was renewed, you might say. We even talked about... well, a sibling for Christopher.”

“Another baby?”

Lady Moss looked a touch sad for a moment, though she sniffed and readjusted her dress, and appeared to hide whatever she had been feeling. “Would you like me to show you around?” she said, affecting a smile with a glint in her eye that turned the page, and suggested she wanted to shock him with whatever was going on inside the building.

“That would be great.”

“Then maybe, we could find a quiet corner somewhere...”

Four

They walked to the steps leading up from the lawn to the terrace, and Jonah felt eyes on him immediately as they joined the party—though after a missed heartbeat or two, he got the impression it was simply because he was accompanying Lady Moss, not that everyone knew he was gatecrashing the party.

While they walked, Jonah managed to surreptitiously check his phone. There was another message from Keeley.

>Found some pictures with your brother in them. Looks like he was fairly active in those Network events. First victim I've seen.

Then Jonah found himself asking Lady Moss straight out: “Did you ever meet my brother at one of these Network things?” It probably wasn’t the wisest of tactics, but he was beginning to warm to Lady Moss, his gut telling him that she might want to help if he was straight with her. She was another next of kin in this murder investigation, after all.

“Your brother...”

“Nate. Oh, I guess he wouldn’t have gone by his real name, though.”

“I met a lot of men,” she said. “It’s quite possible I met your brother. I’m afraid I can’t recall anything specifically.”

Jonah nodded. Perhaps had she been the killer, she would simply have denied ever meeting Nate at all.

Slowly, they drifted among the people out on the terrace, through towards the house itself. Reynolds seemed to make his own way, independent of his employer, yet continuing to keep an eye on her while he paused to capture pictures of other party goers.

There appeared to be a number of clusters of people gather around to watch certain women—wives, Jonah supposed—having fun with jacket-

less men. There were plenty of men and women simply talking amongst themselves, smoking, drinking. Networking, perhaps.

“I heard someone refer to this as a ‘breeding party’,” Jonah said as they approached the House itself, and a long series of archways that led out from the building onto the terrace.

“It is,” Lady Moss nodded. “Do you find that shocking, Mr Fielding?”

“I don’t know... I figured it was some kind of archaic name, maybe referring to ancient fertility rites or something like that.”

She smiled, “I’m not sure how far back the Network goes... but this isn’t just a dance round the Maypole, you know.”

“So what’re you saying? The women here... actually want to get pregnant?” Jonah was a little taken aback at how far this wife-sharing thing went.

They stepped through an archway and into the House, and a long ornate hallway that ran along the length of the building, lined with walnut panels and large oil paintings. At three points along the inner wall, doorways opened into a large ballroom, through which they could see plenty more people—many of them dancing in the middle of the room to the strains of a string orchestra.

Lady Moss said, “I don’t know how many of them want to get pregnant. Some of them might. I guess some of the husbands might like the idea, too... that for this one night, they risk bearing another man’s child.”

“It’s an awful idea!” Jonah exclaimed, under his breath in case they were overheard.

“I dare say it is,” she said, apparently unconcerned at being overheard now the music was so loud over their conversation.

The blonde woman smiled as they stepped into the ballroom, the volume of the music swelling as they merged into the great room. The place was perhaps the size of a football field, with a raised stage at one end on which the small orchestra played. Much of the room was taken up by the dancing, with a ring of husbands—and some wives either pondering

whether to join the dance, or happy just to watch—around the edge of the dance floor. There was no sign of public exposure as there had been out on the terrace—had he not seen that for himself, he might have taken this room to be a fairly conventional ballroom dance.

Lady Moss said: “Some men do seem to like taking risks. I think that’s all this is.”

“And if their wives do get pregnant?”

“From what I’ve heard, they will love those children as though they were their own. No one will know who fathered their child, but some men will see the constant reminder of their wife’s infidelity as a positive thing, I suppose.”

“And if their child looks nothing like the husband?”

Lady Moss shrugged, “Then they say the child was adopted, or some such arrangement.”

They walked around the fringes of the dance floor, and as he assessed the scene, Jonah saw that all of the men out dancing were those wearing white shirts and no jackets. Many of those standing around the edges of the dancing, merely watching, appeared older, and wearing full suits.

“So the wives are out there dancing, and their husbands are here, watching them?” he asked his tour guide.

She nodded, “Many of them will meet a nice young City boy out there, take a few turns with him then decide to retire somewhere for a little more... intimate enjoyment.”

“And the husbands can watch them choose who they want to... sleep with?”

“In some cases, the husband has the final say, but other times they leave it completely up to their wives.”

As they wandered on past the ring of voyeur husbands monitoring the dancing, Jonah periodically caught sight of women leading their white shirted dance partners off the dance floor—and he assumed they had

decided to take things further elsewhere. He could see in their faces the flush of excitement, and the slight sense of incredulity that they were really able to simply lead a relative stranger away to have sex with him. A couple of times, he even caught the expression on the husbands' faces as their wives approached them, escorted by buff suitors—the hints of fear and trepidation, along with clear excitement.

“So all of these women... none of them are on birth control?” he asked, speaking into Lady Moss's ear.

“That's the rule. How many of them abide by it, I can't say. But for all these women, there's a sense that if they break the rules, they could be asked to leave the Network.”

“Wow,” was all Jonah could say.

And he was feeling something, a thickening in his cock, a quickening of his heart rate. Jesus, was it a turn-on for him? He had to think not. This was the ultimate in wife-sharing, and the fantasy might be interesting to him, but if he thought about Emma, there was no way he could want her to actually have children with other men. That would be a step way beyond too far.

Some men, though, with this kind of fantasy, would perhaps want to explore that risk.

Jonah had to imagine that since Emma was here, her undercover role extended to her use of birth control. She wouldn't risk pregnancy just to get the insight into these parties, would she? He couldn't see her anywhere out on the dance floor.

“Women here... they're obligated to take part?” Jonah asked, as they walked around toward the back of the room.

“Oh, no, no. They're expected to attend, of course, if they're members of the Network. But if they don't want to... participate, they can just watch.”

“There's a heck of a lot of women out there on the dance floor.”

“What can I say? It's very easy to get drawn into the excitement of the occasion. It's one night, and you know there is such a thing as a morning

after pill, nowadays.”

“I suppose so.”

“Want to see what happens next?” Lady Moss said, grabbing Jonah’s hand and flashing him a wicked grin as she led him towards the large doorway that seemed to lead out into some kind of large lobby area, or if this was a hotel, its reception.

“I guess...”

As they drifted out of the ballroom, they were overtaken by dance couplets clearly on their way to find a vacant hotel room.

Out in the reception area, there were more people chatting, networking as they had been on the terrace—and some of the women were beginning to get intimate with their male companions.

As they paused there, they saw a forty-something businessman leading his thirty-something wife over to one of the young men waiting at the long reception desk. While the businessman was wearing a smart suit, his brunette wife was in nothing but her underwear, the white lace of her bra and panties seeming almost bridal.

The husband squeezed one of her buttocks as he appeared to give her away to the other man, but then almost immediately the younger man was leaning in to kiss the brunette tenderly, and she was kissing him, her hands working to unfasten the buttons of his shirt, as comfortable with each other as though they’d already been out on a few dates.

“They’ve never met each other?” Jonah whispered.

Lady Moss shook her head. “I don’t know. I guess there is a good chance of meeting men you’ve been with before... especially if you’ve been in the Network a while. But husbands in the Network tend to prefer virgin territory, so to speak.”

They watched the brunette wife turn to kiss her husband as though showing real gratitude, then she took her male companion’s hand, and allowed him to lead her to the large staircase that rose up to a landing on the floor above.

“Come on,” Lady Moss said, dragging Jonah along behind.

The husband—assuming that was who he was—hovered by reception, apparently happy for his wife to venture off on her own, then recognized another man approaching, making it look as though this was simply a break-out area for a simple business conference.

Upstairs, they followed the couple down a long hallway off which many rooms branched off, all their doors open to reveal function rooms. There was food being served out buffet-style, and tables for people to eat. There were also lounge areas complete with armchairs and sofas—where a number of couples were already getting better acquainted.

It was into one of these large sitting rooms that they followed the other couple, and saw as the pair made a beeline for a vacant sofa over by a window.

Lady Moss kept them back at a distance, apparently curious to see what developed without alerting the couple to their presence. Taking up seats on the sofa, the woman was quick to begin exploring her freedoms with this new man.

There were other couples in the room in various stages of undress, but other than the one woman on her knees before her companion, the others seemed only to be venturing as far as kissing and touching each other.

Lady Moss found a place where they could sit and observe, and Jonah saw that others were curious about the brunette wife and her friend as well. Holding each other, kissing passionately, they didn’t seem to care who might be watching them.

“So the husband’s really going to wait downstairs and chat with his buddies while this happens up here?” he whispered to her.

“Maybe. Or maybe he’s just giving them time to get acquainted before he returns to watch.”

“Maybe he’s got some business to conduct? Some networking?”

“Perhaps,” Lady Moss nodded. She seemed to enjoy watching the couple, the woman now helping her younger stud to remove his clothing.

Jonah was a little surprised they might be thinking of taking it all the way right here, in so public a place—but then Emma had gone all the way out on the terrace. There was probably plenty of people who got off on such exposure.

Jonah was too distracted by wondering where Emma was, and what she might be up to by now. He was considering finding some way to excuse himself from Lady Moss's company to go find her, make sure she was safe.

He had to remind himself that Detective Mulray was supposed to be keeping an eye out for her.

Lady Moss quietly nudged him, then flashed her eyes back to the entrance of the room, where the brunette woman's husband now appeared, his eyes darting around before locating his wife.

The man came to sit on the other end of the sofa on which Jonah and Lady Moss perched. His wife saw him there, her eyes connecting with his as the stud stripped down to his boxer shorts, his large erect cock plainly visible through them.

The woman allowed her new lover to remove her bra to reveal small but perky breasts. The husband seemed perfectly happy as she sank down to remove her new lover's underwear, and take his large tool in her hands.

Jonah leaned in to whisper in Lady Moss's ear, "No condoms, I suppose?"

She smiled, and shook her head.

Jonah looked at the husband waiting patiently as his wife knelt between another man's thighs as he sat on the edge of the couch, then sank down onto his hardness. He could understand some of the man's barely-concealed excitement. But not if he imagined that the husband was happy to risk pregnancy.

The click of the camera once again alerted Jonah to the arrival of Reynolds, but when he looked up to locate the man, he caught an expression that might even have been disappointment on the

manservant's face. Had he been expecting more to happen between Jonah and his employer?

Lady Moss turned to acknowledge him with a smile, and Reynolds now approached, then leaned over the back of the couch to murmur something in the blonde woman's ear.

She nodded, then turned to Jonah. "Let's go. Most of the real stuff will be upstairs, come on."

The house was enormous. Jonah couldn't believe the number of rooms there were—and the size of them. Upstairs, the rooms were smaller, and all appeared to be accommodation rather than function rooms, complete with beds and television screens and en suite bathrooms.

All of the rooms were open, for any observer to drift in or out unchallenged, or for exhibitionist couples to find themselves a vacant bed.

There were plenty of voyeurs there, as well as the active participants—and the husbands, who could be relatively easily spotted for their nervous, yet thrilled expressions and the fact they were so riveted to the spot watching their wives stray.

"Does anyone want a little privacy in this place?" Jonah said, as they came upon one room where a suited husband sat on a stool with his pants around his ankles, his erect cock in his hands while he watched his red-haired wife lying on the bed, being pounded by a large and very athletic Asian man.

"Up another floor," Lady Moss replied. "That's where the private rooms are. Plenty of people will want to find their own little place, with or without the husband."

In another room, a similarly well-built blond guy lay spread-eagled on a bed on his back, a blonde straddling his hips while a brunette straddled his face.

"They're both trying for his baby?" Jonah chuckled, feeling that his question was ludicrous, except that he was possibly right.

“Maybe. He looks like a fine specimen,” she smiled. “He’ll probably be in high demand tonight if there are women who do want to conceive...”

The rooms were large, and the en suite bathrooms were sizable too. In one, they found a large shower in which a blonde woman was being seen to by two young men, while the steaming water showered down all over them all.

Jesus.

They ducked out again, and sauntered down to the end of the hallway, past more voyeurs and a couple who seemed to be getting to the early stages of a hook-up.

Jonah’s heart was thumping madly enough already as they walked on—then it was risking breaking through his chest when a familiar face turned out of a doorway to walk calmly past them.

Detective Mulray.

She was wearing a little black dress now. How had she found a way in? He supposed the security hadn’t exactly been intense. She glanced at Jonah only very briefly, acting the stranger though Lady Moss knew exactly who she was. He didn’t have time to fathom what her expression was indicating.

What worried him was that she was supposed to be monitoring Emma. So where was Emma?

Five

“I assume your friend the detective is here under false pretenses,” Lady Moss said.

“I assume so,” he said. “I didn’t know she’d be here. I guess she found someone else to give her the tour.”

“I would have thought she’d need a husband to accompany her here. Unless she’s a confirmed widow, of course.”

“Wives don’t get to play with other women?” Jonah asked, trying to remain calm, though his stomach was filled with butterflies that would not dissipate until he had knowledge of where Emma was. So who had brought Emma to this event, if Lily Foster couldn’t herself?

“Oh normally they do, but these parties are something else.”

They turned into the room that Mulray had left, and Jonah was a little shocked to find Emma standing by a low, king-sized bed in the middle of the room, completely naked, stretching up to wrap her arms around a gray-haired man in an expensive suit, to kiss him passionately.

Was this the man she had come with this evening, a fake husband?

There were various men lingering around the edges of the room watching—Jonah counted about 15—with most of them in suits or tuxedos, but three of the younger men stood naked.

Jonah felt as though someone had dropped a hot stone in his stomach: was Emma’s fake husband giving her to these men?

“Well, there she is. Isn’t she a pretty one?” Lady Moss observed as they drifted in to lurk among the other voyeurs. He wondered if Reynolds had alerted her to Emma’s location, since she’d shown an interest earlier.

Jonah took a step back, trying to conceal himself behind another man so that Emma might not see him there.

“She’s getting them all?” he said, meaning it rhetorically.

But Lady Moss only stirred up the butterflies in his stomach as she answered him: “Oh yes, isn’t she the lucky one?”

The three men looked relatively average, though they clearly looked after themselves with regular gym memberships. All had short dark hair, two of them were relatively tall, while the shorter man was the only one who had a light dusting of hair on his chest. One of the taller men had a small tattoo on one bicep that appeared to be some kind of coat of arms. The tallest of the three appeared to be of mixed race, his warm skin tone and attractive physique seeming to draw Lady Moss’s eye as she looked the men over.

“They’re all City traders?” he asked Lady Moss quietly.

“Oh yes,” she said, smiling knowingly. “And they’re all very good. She’s a very lucky girl.”

“You know them?”

Lady Moss flashed her eyes at him, “Bruno, the biggest one, used to work for my husband, some years ago.”

“And your husband introduced him to you?”

“How could he not?”

Emma broke apart from her fake husband, and Jonah had to stifle a gasp at the recognition that the man was the husband of the red-haired woman he’d taken in front of their dinner guests at the private hotel in Chelsea. So was he really Lydia’s husband? Or had he faked that too?

The man turned Emma to face the three naked men, presenting her to them, offering her to them.

Lady Moss whispered excitedly to Jonah: “Look at her tremble slightly. She’s never done this before.”

Jonah could well see his beloved trying to hide her nerves as she perched on the corner of the bed, facing three lustful naked men. She obviously found the men attractive, but all of this was quite a lot to take in, even for someone as apparently wild and free-spirited as Emma, and she did look a little startled. It was surprisingly cute.

And in fact, the whole thing was surprisingly thrilling for Jonah. As the initial shock wore off, he found himself curious to see how far Emma would take this—and that strange dark place within him wanted to find out how much pleasure these men could give her.

“The one with the tattoo is Matthew,” Lady Moss said. “He’s been going a while, too. But the other one... I think his name’s Patrick.”

“You’ve not been with him?” Jonah gently teased her.

But she took the wind out of his sails, replying, “I did at one point... during a dinner last year... I think it may have been the one thrown by the Chief Constable, you know.”

Jonah almost found himself laughing at that—except that his attention was suddenly drawn back to what was happening in the centre of the room.

The men surrounded Emma, their cocks all held out, hard for her.

She didn’t look as though she quite knew what to do with them all, glancing back to her fake-husband as though for guidance. The gray-haired man was sitting on a chair in the corner of the room, just watching now. Encouraging her with only a smile.

The tallest man, Bruno, urged her up onto her feet, and the three of them closed in on her. The tattooed man, Matthew, leaning in for a gentle kiss of the mouth, the other two men touching her body softly, running their hands over her curves.

“You’ve done this?” Jonah asked Lady Moss, almost forgetting how personal a question it was, particularly since the last occasion he’d met her, she’d denied any talk of wife-sharing or open relationships.

But now, it seemed they had a bond of trust. She'd admitted she'd been with these men before.

Lady Moss said quietly, "A few times, in the old days. Douglas used to love watching me being swamped by a sea of men."

Swamped. God. Emma was being swamped by these men. Their hands all over her, their cocks occasionally brushing against her. Bruno was reaching around to stroke her pussy now, while Matthew gave way to allow the shorter man, Patrick, to kiss her as he himself moved to fondle her breasts.

She was enjoying the attention, it appeared. And enjoying being watched by the voyeurs in the room, and especially her fake-husband. She made a good show of doing this for his benefit, of looking over to him, of seeming grateful for his gift of these men.

Who was he? It couldn't be a coincidence that he was here, playing the husband for Emma. Had Mulray set them up following that night she'd watched Jonah with Lydia?

"Do you know who the husband is?" he whispered to Lady Moss.

She looked blankly at him. "I think I've seen before, but I've not been introduced."

Jonah managed to keep away from Emma's occasional glances at the men watching her. He thought he might not be able to forever, though. Yet he wanted to stay, wanted to watch her.

If she wanted to test him, to see that he could accept her continuing to have fun with other guys while in a relationship with him, then she would see that he could handle it.

It wasn't entirely easy to handle, though. Seeing their paws all over her, her breasts, her buttocks, her pussy. He was burning inside with jealousy, while at the same time turned on like never before.

He was so hard watching all those hands running through her hair, over her body, cupping her breasts, delving between her thighs. The lips

kissing her lips, the fingers slipping inside her wet pussy. His heart was beating so quickly he could have been running an Olympic race.

It was a grueling experience for Jonah—and yet at the same time magnificent, exhilarating.

Three hard cocks were straining at the leash, desperate for the chance to enter his wicked girlfriend.

She was touching them now, her hands curling around two cocks, as the third man knelt to focus his fingers on her pussy. Pumping them slowly, loving the presence of so much strange cock around her, all so large and stiff in response to her standing between them.

Then Jonah felt his stomach tighten as he saw Emma kneel down on the corner of the bed, and kiss the top of Matthew's cock before stretching her lips around it, then sinking down on him. Jonah's heart seemed to skip a beat, but his cock was pulsating in his pants to see her suck on that thing, then withdraw to circle her tongue around his shiny tip.

Bruno had his hand on the back of Emma's head, and began to gently guide her movement as she slowly rose and fell on the tattooed man's pole. Her spare hand was around the larger man's cock, but she could hardly concentrate on much more than squeezing him.

Patrick had been penetrating her with a finger or two, but now dropped down to nuzzle into her behind, and run his tongue over her pussy.

“Do you wish you were one of them?” Lady Moss asked, sounding a trifle breathless herself at watching all this.

Jonah was somewhat struck dumb by it all.

“Or maybe you really wish you were the husband,” she teased him, and didn't realize how close to the truth she was getting.

Beside them, they heard a click, and Jonah looked up to see Reynolds there in his smart suit, holding the camera Jonah had seen him with in the study the night of his break-in. He was firing off picture after picture of Emma. Jonah felt awkward that her under cover performance was being

recorded in this way—even if the pictures would remain strictly guarded, they would be shared with other members of the Network.

He wondered if there might be an opportunity to get to that camera, and delete at least the images that showed her face. Yet he hoped another break-in would not be necessary.

Emma had moved over to take Bruno's huge cock into her mouth, but as the two larger men stood beside each other, Jonah saw that in actual fact she was freely switching between the two of them, enjoying them effectively both at the same time.

Occasionally she glanced over at the gray-haired man, sharing some kind of look that told him how much fun she was having—and Jonah did have to admit, he did wish he was her husband in this moment.

A husband who would get to have her once her night was done.

He tried to calm himself down a little by asking Lady Moss a question—getting back to the whole point he was here, which was supposedly to find out more about the Network and events like these.

“Are all the men at this party in the City?”

Lady Moss looked bemused at him for a moment or two, at how he could think about anything other than the fact that a blonde beauty was indulging in three different men in front of them.

But either she figured he was here, after all, to find out more about who killed his brother, or she realized he was just trying to remain level-headed, for her expression melted.

“I should imagine so,” she said. “As far as I know, this whole thing started out as some kind of exclusive club for the married guys in the City. The ones who couldn't just go out with the younger guys and pick up girls at bars.”

“When did it all start?”

She shrugged, “I'm not really sure. This kind of thing's been going on for years—decades, probably.”

Jonah was silent again as he saw Patrick standing up, his hard cock in one hand, guiding it up to Emma. God. How could it be so difficult to watch, and yet so pleasurable at the same time? So thrilling, and yet so frightening.

The guy planted his spare hand on her body, then touched his tip between her buttocks. And he slid into her so easily.

“And the women really are here to get pregnant?” he asked Lady Moss in hushed tones. Trying desperately to cope with the rush of feelings tearing through his body.

Emma continued sucking on the two cocks in front of her, as Patrick started up a rhythm, the rocking of her body changing to align with his thrusts, rather than her bobbing on the other men’s shafts.

Her moans, growing louder and louder, seemed to provoke pulses of arousal in Jonah’s own granite-hard cock.

“Some of them, I’m sure, will be hoping to get pregnant,” Lady Moss said. “But they might go home with their husbands, and you never know, it might be their husbands that get the actual credit. I’ve heard of that happening.”

“Some of them are just doing it for the risk, though?”

She nodded. “Some of those will have babies with other men, too. And their husbands will love them as though they were their own.”

“I can’t understand it,” Jonah said. “I mean, I see why they would want their wives to have fun like this... I just can’t see why they would want their wives to get pregnant with someone else.”

Lady Moss smiled, “They have their different reasons, I’m sure. They get to the stage of their careers where they want their wives to be happy and occupied so they can achieve big things...”

They watched as Patrick withdrew from Emma, and now it was Matthew, the guy with the tattoo on his arm, who lined up behind her and slid inside her. The smaller man stepped round to Emma’s head, leaning down to kiss her mouth, grateful perhaps, for his enjoyment of her sex.

He was still hard, though, and now guided his cock to her mouth, holding her hair out of the way for her to sink down on him.

“Your husband took you to some of these,” Jonah said.

Lady Moss nodded. “In the old days we just observed, and maybe we might sneak off to a bathroom stall for a little release, but I stayed on my birth control, so I wasn’t permitted to take part in the main proceedings.”

“But later you broke the rules?” Jonah suggested, thinking to himself that he hoped it was possible, that there weren’t some kind of checks. That Emma could be breaking the rules right now, that she wasn’t risking pregnancy here.

“Oh, we were pretty good,” Lady Moss said. “Then... after Christopher came along... I suppose Doug was happy we had our own little one... he didn’t mind the idea of me having others to occupy me.”

Emma took Bruno in her mouth again, a much more challenging task than sucking on Patrick, but this time the tall man stood so that she could look directly into the eyes of her fake-husband as she did so.

Wow. Did she enjoy teasing him? Would she want to tease Jonah if they ever did something like this together?

“So you did come to these... as an active participant?” Jonah asked Lady Moss.

“Only really a couple of times before Doug... passed away.”

“But nothing came of it, right?”

She shook her head. “Women don’t necessarily get pregnant just because they’ve had sex during their fertile periods.”

Matthew was really hammering into Emma, one of his feet lifted up onto the bed so that the voyeurs in the room could see him entering her. Who were these voyeurs? They mostly seemed older, forty- and fifty-something, peers of the husbands in this Network.

“Who are all these other guys? All these guys watching,” Jonah asked in a quiet whisper, though the other men around them were so wrapped up

in what was happening to Emma that they probably couldn't hear what he was talking about with Lady Moss.

The room was getting stiflingly hot, and by now the scent of sex was strong in the air. Emma's scent. Patrick was reaching under Emma to play with her clit while she sucked on Bruno, and while Matthew continued to thrust into her from behind. From her shrill moans, it seemed she was close to climax.

Emma's "husband" just watched, interested but calm. Was he thinking about Lydia being in a situation like this? If, indeed, Lydia was his wife.

"Some of them are members whose wives don't want to participate in anything this... extreme. Some might be men whose wives just aren't available for this one," Lady Moss said, then paused as Emma went through an obvious climax, her body shivering and shaking as she cried out with glorious, unbridled joy.

Jonah watched in fascinated horror as Matthew withdrew his glistening cock from the beautiful blonde, and it was clear that he had just come inside her. Silently, he prayed she was still on some kind of birth control.

He loved her, he wanted her so badly, even if it turned him on brutally that she could be naughty with other men. But he didn't want her to be into the fantasy to such an extreme—and it terrified him to think that this extreme experience she was having might mean she no longer wanted him.

Lady Moss continued, "Some of them might have wives somewhere else here, of course."

"They don't want to watch their wives?"

"Not all husbands do, you know," Lady Moss smiled. "Besides, there is business to be done as well. It is a Network, there's networking to do."

"Right. So they might talk about... I don't know... hot prospects for investing?"

A small nod, then she said: "And you know, increasingly I see female traders bringing their husbands to the Network so they can benefit, too—"

but the City is still a very male-dominated place, of course.”

“But they don’t bring their husbands to share them?”

“It doesn’t really work that way. Some of them might partake of these young men, though, if their husbands are willing.”

As they watched, the gray-haired man playing Emma’s husband was now up on his feet, and the other men were giving way to allow her up to embrace him, and whisper sweet nothings to him as she put her arms around him and kissed him.

Jonah’s jealousy welled up—this tenderness with the older men was worse than her having sex with three men. The way she was looking at the man—elated, thankful, flirtatious—was how she should have been looking at Jonah.

He felt a slight nausea in his stomach, it almost became too much, but then the man was leading her back to the bed, and it almost seemed like a relief that Emma would be simply getting back down to the physical side of her transgression.

Would she be sleeping with the husband at the end of the night? He hoped not, not if the man was only playing a role for this under cover mission. But who knew what Emma was doing any more?

Emma allowed the man to help her onto the bed again, this time urging her to lie down on her back. The three naked men were still there, circling like sharks.

Then as the husband retired back to his corner chair, the men surrounded Emma, and it was Bruno kneeling on the bed between her open thighs, the other two up by her head.

Jonah was thinking to himself that Emma and her “husband” might have got their positioning wrong—perhaps something that real couples might notice—because she was now facing away from the man sitting in the corner chair. Then suddenly, he saw that Emma was in direct line of sight, and it had to be hard for her to miss seeing him standing there among her other admirers.

He felt the shock explode inside his heart as her eyes connected with his. He saw her visibly shaken by seeing him there, though she tried to hide it while Bruno took up position on the bed, slipping his hands over her pussy to prepare her for him. She blanched for a moment, and then blushed.

Bruno was laughing, imagining that her reaction came from laying eyes on his large cock as it was about to enter her for the first time.

“Be gentle with me,” Emma said, thinking quickly to play to his assumptions.

“Of course,” the man replied to her. Emma glanced back at Jonah with fearful, questioning eyes.

Jonah found himself enjoying the moment. His beautiful girlfriend was surrounded by naked men, and the way she was looking at him, suddenly it all seemed to be his gift to give to her. And right now, he wanted nothing less than for her to have it, and to enjoy it fully.

He smiled, and gave a slight nod to signal his approval. The smile she gave him in return was the most beautiful thing he’d seen all evening. Then he saw her eyes fall, checking on his sexual response to watching her. He moved his hand out of the way to show her the hardness straining at his pants.

Emma managed to make her giggle seem as though it was prompted by Bruno moving in, resting that monster cock on her mound.

But she gave Jonah one more sweet little smile before turning her head to take Matthew’s offered cock briefly into her mouth again, before Bruno’s slow slide inside her made her look up at him and gasp.

“He’s a big boy, isn’t he?” Lady Moss whispered in Jonah’s ear. Had she seen the looks he’d been sharing with Emma? Well, what did it matter now? Lady Moss certainly wasn’t going to throw anyone out of this place. He could explain everything to Lady Moss later.

“Certainly is,” he said in reply.

“I think when I had him for the night, he stretched me so much I couldn’t feel any other man inside me for a week.” There was a glint in her eye at that.

Emma was back sucking on Matthew as Bruno slowly thrust into her, and she was moaning loudly despite her mouth being filled. She was somehow managing to pump the third man’s cock while this was going on, impressing Jonah with her multitasking skills.

God, it was incredible to watch her being taken like this. Two men holding her legs up and apart for a brute of a third man to fuck her. She was switching back and forth between the two cocks hanging over her face, and loving it. Loving being so “swamped” by men.

“Look at her taking him,” Lady Moss seemed as riveted as Jonah was. “She’s magnificent.”

Jonah saw that huge thing penetrating her, and how it gleamed with her wetness. It was just a toy she was playing with, and it was so hot to see her doing it.

As they watched, the men helped Emma up onto her hands and knees, with Patrick now lining up behind her. Again, she was facing Jonah more than her fake-husband, and as she began rocking from the force of Patrick’s thrusting, she looked up and directly into Jonah’s eyes, unable to keep from smiling at his obvious enjoyment of her fun.

As the shorter man glided inside her, Jonah wondered if she could even feel him, having had Bruno inside her. And yet the sexual ecstasy on her face was as real as it could be—and such a powerful thrill for Jonah.

“She seems to like you,” Lady Moss whispered, and Jonah wasn’t sure whether to deny it or admit who Emma was.

Instead, he just shrugged, played dumb. “I guess she likes an audience.”

He tried to give Emma a hint through a warning glance, that she shouldn’t make it too obvious that she knew him.

He realized his concern stemmed not from Lady Moss finding out who she was, but the possibility that others in the Network—the ones that had

followed him, perhaps, or perhaps even the killer herself—would find out they were being infiltrated.

“She’ll go far in this network,” Lady Moss smiled, adding: “Although I suppose she might have to wait nine months or so...”

Jonah felt his stomach fold over. He had to tell himself that Emma wouldn’t play around with those kind of risks.

“You think there’s a chance that one of these guys will get her pregnant?” he whispered to his guide to the party.

Lady Moss smiled, “One of these guys, or one of the others she’ll probably see after them.”

“Right.”

“My guess is she’s trying for a baby,” Lady Moss’s words stunk him. “The women like that tend to go for as many men during the event as they possibly can.”

The thought burned through Jonah’s consciousness. Jesus. And how would he react if Emma did ever conceive with another man? No—she would take a morning after pill after this, he was certain.

“And it works? There’s more chance of her getting pregnant if more men sleep with her?”

Lady Moss shrugged, “Who knows? But that’s how it is here.”

Emma looked at Lady Moss talking to Jonah, and seemed to catch the gist of what he was trying to warn her about. She turned to take Matthew’s cock in her mouth, Bruno once again guiding her motion on the other man, as she gripped the big man’s cock in her spare hand.

What a ride—from her moans and cries, it was hard to tell where one orgasm stopped and another started, it seemed like one long train of sexual bliss for her.

They watched as Matthew slid under her, Matthew giving way so that Emma could sit up on the tattooed man, taking his cock inside her while

she sat facing her fake-husband. Taking her performance back to its original intended script.

The man in the chair was doing a good job at acting the cuckolded husband, portraying some of the angst while also displaying his excitement without going over the top. Was he imagining Lydia in Emma's place? Had Emma persuaded him to do this as some kind of dry-run for his own wife to experience this kind of debauchery?

Perhaps Emma had him persuaded that this kind of thing might be the next step for his red-haired wife after sex in front of their dinner guests.

"Look, they're close to the finish line," Lady Moss said.

Jonah came out of a slight daze he'd slipped into while watching Emma bouncing on Matthew's lap, to find her lying down on her side, as though she was tired and she needed sleep. Patrick took up behind her on the bed, and as he positioned himself on his side, she raised her leg, inviting him inside her.

Now Emma's fake-husband stepped up, and knelt down by the bed, cradling her head in his hands before leaning in to kiss her.

Patrick was firing up his pace as he fucked Emma, his whole body shaking and jiggling as he rammed into her. But her eyes were on her husband, kissing him tenderly, murmuring to him sweetly about something as she took the other man inside her.

At the same time she was able to tug on Matthew's cock, but Bruno had to stand and watch.

Jonah was more tense about Emma's tender kissing with Lydia's husband than about the man—men—fucking her. But as he saw Patrick gearing up for the home straight, his face and chest all red with effort as he powered his way toward the finish, suddenly it all seemed a little too much for Jonah.

He saw Patrick's cock sliding in and out of Emma's smooth, gorgeous pussy, and then the man ground to a sudden halt, and he was pumping his come deep into her.

“I need some air,” Jonah said to Lady Moss quietly. “It’s too hot in here.”

Lady Moss nodded, seeming to accept it without objection as behind them, Matthew now replaced Patrick between Emma’s thighs.

She put a hand on his shoulder, “Come on, lets get out of here.”

He felt regret the instant he turned his back on Emma, but she was somewhat absorbed by her men, and facing her fake husband as they slowly made their way toward the door. He did want to see her, did want to watch whatever she got up to—but he couldn’t deny he was feeling a little too light-headed for comfort. His body was telling him that if he didn’t get some fresh air, and calm down, it all might just overwhelm him.

Nevertheless, he hung back a little, and on the way out the door he turned to catch a glimpse of the tattooed man emptying himself inside the pretty blonde, Bruno waiting behind her to step in himself.

Out in the hallway, Lady Moss was amused at him being caught in the doorway by his own curiosity. But then she was recognized by a married couple wandering past, and they distracted her with a little light conversation.

Jonah watched Matthew finishing up, and Bruno hauling Emma up onto her hands and knees. With the come of two men already inside her, it was much easier for him to enter her this time, that great pole plunging into her tight pussy as the man held her fast with a hand on her waist.

Jonah would never forget the ecstatic cries Emma let out as the big man fucked her hard, but far from horrifying him or taking his jealousy to intolerable levels, it had the strange effect of cementing his need to possess Emma yet share her with whomever she desired.

Then Bruno was grunting loudly, almost roaring as he slammed into her one last time, and Emma came with a great shuddering yell as the brute filled her with his hot seed.

Jonah had to fight his instinct to go back in there and reclaim Emma in front of her suitors and all of the other men watching.

Lady Moss grabbed his hand and dragged him away.

Six

Lady Moss led him out of there, and further along the hallway until they reached a stairway up to the next floor. Reynolds accompanied them, sometimes ducking into the occasional room to scout out possible photo opportunities, but generally sticking fairly close.

“How long has your... has Reynolds been photographing these events?” Jonah asked casually, now finding his thoughts drifting to how Keeley might be getting on breaking into Lady Moss’s computer over in Chiswick.

“Oh, years and years,” Lady Moss said, seeming relaxed about it. “Started out, he just took pictures of me so that Doug could follow my progress at these things, but turns out he’s got a very good eye for pictures, so when Doug floated the pictures around to his friends in the Network... well, there were requests for him to capture other wives too. He’s more of an official event photographer now.”

“But it still seems as though you’re his favorite model,” Jonah said, as Reynolds clicked a few shots of him walking with Lady Moss.

“He’s very loyal,” she smiled. Then, as they reached the top of the stairway, she added, “These are where the more... intimate encounters take place.”

“Private rooms?”

“Some private, some not so. Doors are rarely locked at these events.”

“I see.”

“Come on,” Lady Moss’s eyes blazed. “Maybe we’ll find a spare bed somewhere. We can give something decent for poor Reynolds to snap.”

Jonah felt his heart skip a beat at the prospect of being photographed engaging in any kind of sordid activity. Lady Moss clearly saw his

expression, and it made her laugh.

“Hey,” she said, “don’t look so worried! I’ll even give you final approval on the photographs we keep.”

After an obvious pause, he nodded.

“Come to think of it, you might want to see some of our archive of photos from past events,” Lady Moss said. “You know... if you’re still thinking the killer is a member.”

Now that was interesting. Suddenly Jonah regretted breaking into Lady Moss’s house, and encouraging Keeley to do so repeatedly.

“That might be useful,” he said, trying to strike a balance between seeming interested and seeming overly keen.



Up here, the floor seemed more like a regular hotel, with rooms spaced fairly evenly along the more narrow hallways, and with doors not only closed but locked, many with ‘do not disturb’ signs hanging on the handles.

“Here,” Lady Moss said, pulling Jonah into the first room with an unlocked door. “It’s perfect.”

“Perfect?”

She flashed her eyes, “Empty.”

The bed was hardly pristine—the room had been used before, the covers strewn by the previous couple or group, but Jonah was hardly going to object.

The door closed behind them, and Reynolds was already firing off photographs of Lady Moss, even before she got to the bed.

“You two are more than just a dutiful servant and his employer, aren’t you?” Jonah said.

“How d’you mean?”

He shrugged, but inside he was afraid she’d realize he knew more than he should about her relationship with her servant, something he might only have gathered from watching them in action, from breaking into her home.

“He’s taking pictures of you even before you do anything,” Jonah said, trying to cobble some kind of deduction that might lead him to the conclusion he needed. “He’s not just some official Network photographer, and not just taking souvenir snaps for his employer.”

“Not only, no.”

“You were together—are together, aren’t you?”

“If you must know...”

“And he enjoys your infidelity, doesn’t he?”

Lady Moss had fire in her eyes, but as Reynolds drew close to her, she surprised the servant by pulling him to her for a kiss, then down onto the bed next to her. “You’re very perceptive, Jonah. Does it matter to you?”

The beautiful blonde looked at her servant with unabashed adoration. Jonah envied him. Was that how Emma might feel about him, if he allowed her free rein in their own relationship?

“Was he your lover before your husband came along?” he asked. Might as well get it out there. If she was the killer, at least he was unshackled, he might defend himself.

“Uh-huh,” she said, her smile so broad as she kissed Reynolds again. She was proud of him, it seemed, proud of what he’d been through for her. “Are you going to tell your detective friend?” She reached for the servant’s crotch, running her hand over his bulge.

“Not if it has nothing to do with any of this,” he said. “But some might think you two plotted to kill your husband. His money... well, it’s good

motive.”

Lady Moss stroked Reynolds, and said quietly to him, “You’re so hard. You’re always so hard...” Then she turned to Jonah, and signaled for him to get rid of his clothes. “Why would I kill my husband for his money?” she asked, and there on the bed, she now turned her back to Reynolds, to allow him to unzip her dress, to pull it off her body for the benefit of another man. “I already had his money. I had his title, I had the lifestyle—and he let me sleep with whoever I wanted.”

Jonah had to admit, the freedom her husband had allowed her, and the acceptance of her lover, Reynolds, for her seeing other men as well, did dilute the power of suspicion surrounding her.

“I suppose it was a fairly nice arrangement for you,” he said as he dropped his pants, removed his shirt.

“And if anything, not having Douglas around any more has made me less financially secure,” Lady Moss said, kneeling up to signal with her fingers for Jonah to remove his underwear. “Hardly motive for me to kill him.”

“Less secure?”

She sighed, “You know how it is—the rest of the family start sharpening their lawyers so they can pick over Douglas’s will in minute detail. So tiresome.”

Reynolds moved to the other side of the bed, picked up his camera again. Jonah had been with wives in front of their husbands before, but this felt stranger. Whether it was because Reynolds was so close, and so obviously obsessed with Lady Moss, because he wasn’t her husband but her long-term lover, or because Jonah had watched them before making love, it just seemed different.

He climbed onto the bed, just a few feet from Reynolds, his hands touching down on her slender waist as she leaned in for a kiss, her own hands reaching for his growing hardness. Her lips were bitter from Champagne, but so eager, her heat and softness adding a sweetness to her kiss.

“You have a nice big one,” she said, her comments designed to affect Reynolds, Jonah knew well enough.

He leaned down to take one of her hard nipples in his mouth as she began to pump his cock in her tight grip.

Reynolds paused in his photography efforts, just watched his mistress a while as she was consumed by the sexual feelings flowing through her. So many years the man must have witnessed his lover’s infidelity—including a long while when she’d even been married to someone else—and yet he still seemed obsessed by watching her.

Lady Moss pushed Jonah onto his back, sitting up to reach for his cock. “This is what I want,” she said, pulling on it, kneeling down to guide it to her mouth.

It was Jonah’s turn to groan as she held his cock, opened her mouth and rest the tip on her tongue, before stretching her lips around his end, and slowly sinking down his shaft. In the background, he could hear the camera clicking again, Reynolds capturing the moment as his love sucked on another man.

Her lips smacked as she withdrew from him. “Mmm...” she purred, for her long-term lover’s benefit more than Jonah’s. She was teasing him. Jonah gasped as she took him back into the heat of her mouth again, bobbing down on him while her hand coaxed the base of his shaft.

Moving on him slowly, giving Reynolds plenty of time to witness it, to capture it on camera.

Jonah found himself thinking about how it might be to be standing behind that camera, to be watching so intently the taking of the woman he really did love. The beautiful blonde relinquished his cock, straddled him, positioned him so that her hot sex held the end of his manhood in place, ready. And Jonah was thinking of Emma, of how it was to watch her—and he was unable to keep from thinking that way.

Jonah caught a lingering glance Lady Moss gave Reynolds, the man’s camera shutter firing more rapidly to capture the anticipation, the moments immediately before penetration. Then she sank, and took Jonah deep inside her perennially unfaithful pussy.

She was tight, despite her insatiability, and riding him, her trim body and pretty face made it seem why guys like Douglas Moss might give her the benefit of the doubt just to sleep with her, before dealing with the question of her polyamorous nature.

“Oh God...” she breathed. “You feel... magnificent.”

Reynolds leaned in to photograph Lady Moss’s face up close, making Jonah suspect that perhaps men she slept with weren’t always so happy for a photographer to be so close—leading him to make the most of the opportunity.

Lady Moss beckoned her servant over, and he leaned in to kiss her while she continued to ride Jonah.

Later, as Lady Moss dismounted, and presented her behind for Jonah, her beloved servant seemed in some kind of ecstatic daze as he floated around them, taking countless pictures. The man’s pants were straining to contain his arousal.

“Fuck me... fuck me...” she urged him, and standing by the bed while she knelt on the edge of the mattress, he drove into her hard, harder than he might ordinarily, though she seemed to want it that way.

When Jonah’s end finally came, his hot seed erupting inside her as he held tightly onto her waist, no one seemed more joyous than the smartly-dressed butler.



Afterwards, Jonah even caught a hint of gratitude on the other man’s face.

“Could you give us a moment?” Lady Moss asked him, seeming almost to surprise herself that she would ask it of him, of a date. Jonah got the impression that normally Reynolds didn’t get this close to her while she

was with another man, that her other men weren't quite as accepting of him.

"Sure," Jonah said, reaching for his clothes. Was that it for his time with Lady Moss and her strange servant?

But she said, "Why don't you meet us in the lobby when we're done? We could take you back, show you those photos."

It was only as he was walking out of the room that he recalled the requirements for this evening's event for the wives to be free from birth control. He turned, wanting clarification that there was no risk here, that she hadn't strictly complied with the requirement.

But she was already engaged. Silently, he peered around the corner formed by the ensuite, and saw the servant lying on his back on the bed, Lady Moss sitting astride his face. He was moaning as much as she was.

Jonah watched as the man pleased his employer with his mouth, before she moved to fish his hard cock out from his fly, and take him inside her, just minutes after another man.

Seven

He did leave them to it—Lady Moss obviously needed her private time with Reynolds. But it also gave Jonah a chance to check up on Keeley's progress. On the way down to the lobby of the hotel, Jonah managed to discretely send a text to the reporter asking how things were going. Keeley's reply came only a few moments later:

>Almost got caught by the nanny. After she put the kid to bed, she came in the study to use the computer. Thankfully I was on my way out, managed to hide in time.

Jonah let out his breath. Having been with Lady Moss and having garnered an invitation to do what Keeley had been trying to do illegally—it would be ridiculous to get caught now. Did he dare tell the reporter that his whole breaking and entering mission was now rendered pointless?

He texted back:

>Are you out of the study? Are you safe?

After a moment or two, Keeley replied:

>Out of the study, just heading out of the house now. Been nosing around a little while nanny's absorbed in her email. You free for a call?

Jonah replied:

>Sure. Call me when you're somewhere safe, away from the house.

He wandered down to the stairs, and descended to the lower floor, where the rooms were less private, the doors either open or openable. While he waited for Keeley's call, and Lady Moss to finish with Reynolds for that matter, his mind turned to where Emma might be. Was she done for the night after her extraordinary adventure with all those men at once?

With time on his hands, he found himself ducking into the rooms that he passed, hoping just to see that she was there, that she was safe.

A lot of the rooms simply had couples on beds in various states of undress, enjoying themselves in front of a smattering of observers—perhaps a husband and his friends, perhaps just strangers, Jonah didn't stop to find out.

In one room, two men wearing suits sat bound to chairs to watch young women—presumably their wives—cavorting with three young men. In another, a 30-something brunette lay on a bed sandwiched between two powerful men wearing nothing but their shirts, both of them penetrating her at the same time, her cries as much from astonishment as pleasure, though there appeared to be no one really watching them. There was also a room where he found two wives happily sharing a younger man, a blonde tending to him orally while her brunette friend knelt over his face.

Eventually, after trying most of the rooms along that floor, it seemed, he found her. He was relieved to see she was simply lying on a bed with Lily Foster, Lily on her back, Emma leaning over her, covering her breasts with her hands, the two of them kissing slowly, tenderly. It seemed to Jonah almost as though she was recovering from her bout with all those men with the soft attentions of this older woman.

Once again she had an audience, and Jonah wondered if she might have found a taste for that. He could see the guy who had been acting as her husband was among the small collective hovering around the bed.

Of course he stopped to watch them, how could he not? They were beautiful together. It still seemed a little funny to Jonah—Emma should be so jealous, react so badly to his spending time with Lily, and now here she was sharing a bed, sharing a kiss. Her hand drifted down Lily's body to delve between her thighs, then not long after her lips were kissing a trail down the same route, until the pretty blonde was lying between her legs, planting soft kisses around her open flower, before going in for the kill.

No sign of Mulray anywhere, though perhaps she was watching via a camera positioned somewhere. It seemed to Jonah, though, that somehow they had Lily in on the act as a minder for the amateur sleuth among them. It made Jonah feel a little more assured that Emma was

safe, at any rate. If it was up to him, she could spend the rest of the night with Lily, and that would be for the best.

Lily Foster was certainly enjoying Emma's attentions, lying back and softly moaning as she was licked and tongued, one hand supporting her head under a pillow, while the other held Emma's hand and squeezed it in time with her pulse.

The audience of about 15 men were transfixed by the bed and the angels writhing on it—but they were not entirely silent. Jonah didn't initially pick up on the murmur of conversation in that large room, but now that he noticed it, he found that it wasn't English. Some kind of Eastern European language, possibly Russian. Lots of consonants.

Lily came, her cheeks and chest flushing gentle pink as Emma drew out her climax, the older woman looking down in wonder at her as it finally subsided.

Jonah felt the temptation burn in his chest, the arousal throbbing in his hard cock, but whether or not he might have braved the audience, he knew he had to wait for Keeley's call. As he watched and waited, however, a young white-shirted man did step through the other voyeurs to approach the bed, and nobody moved to stop him. He crouched next to Lily, and she merely turned her head to kiss him, her hand slipping round the back of his neck.

Moments later, the young man was lying naked on the bed himself, embracing Lily as he gently fingered her, Emma's oral focus moving to his large cock.

Was this how it was? The young traders simply wandered from room to room, taking up with whichever wives they found available? Or had Emma's fake husband sent some kind of an order out for a man to join this particular bed?

When he felt the phone buzzing in his pocket, and knew he had to get out of there, he felt huge regrets more than any kind of jealousy. To have to leave just as Emma was about to take another man inside her sweet, wicked pussy.

Still, Lily was there. Stroking Emma's hair out of her face as the man guided his large member inside her, the two women looking into each others' eyes, looking every bit like best friends trying on clothes at a store together, rather than trying on men.



“Hey, so you having any luck at the big party?” Keeley asked as Jonah accepted the call, once he'd found a quiet corner where nobody would see him with a phone. The reporter was speaking in a hushed voice, his heavy breathing sounding as though he was still on the move.

Jonah said, “I suppose so. Found my friend—I think she's okay. And, I connected with Lady Moss, would you believe.”

“You did? Nice. She remember you from your visit?”

“She did, and she's actually talking about helping me with this whole thing—volunteered to let me see those photos.”

“Jesus. So my whole gig was pointless, right?”

“Well, I'm not sure...”

“No. I think I got something,” the reporter said. “This means you can check it out with a little more time.”

“What was it?”

“There's a lot of pictures on that computer, but I flicked through them. Your brother was quite active in that Network.”

“He was?”

“And your friend Lily Foster. Her husband, too, I guess.”

Jonah said, “Well I found out she's a member of the Network—she's here somewhere, tonight.”

“Funny she didn’t say anything to you before.”

Jonah said, “Mmm. But I don’t think I ever actually asked her about it. So maybe she just never had the opportunity to bring it up.”

“She knew what you were looking into, though. Knew her husband was involved in it, too.”

“I suppose so.” Jonah felt a knot of irritation in his stomach, that Lily hadn’t mentioned the Network—she might have helped him infiltrate this thing a lot sooner. But she was here with Emma now, so it wasn’t as though she was still hiding it. It might be in Emma and Mulray’s hands, but Lily was opening up to somebody about her involvement with the Network.

He asked Keeley, “So you saw all of the victims in the pictures?”

The reporter replied, “Most of them here and there, but it wasn’t until you go back four years, to another one of those big Breeding Parties, that you get all of them at the one event.”

Jonah drew in his breath. All of the murder victims pictured at a single event. That had to be significant, didn’t it? It felt a little like stretching to a conclusion, but they didn’t have a huge amount to do otherwise.

“Four years ago, though,” Jonah said. “Why if they were all there four years ago, are they being killed now, or at least in the last year or so?”

“No idea,” Keeley said, though he didn’t seem particularly despondent. His tone suggested that given time, they might figure something out. “Anyway,” he continued, so I looked a little more closely at that event, four years ago. And when you get to look at them, you can spend some time on those.”

“Right. You see anything interesting?”

“I think you can see Julian Foster having an argument with his wife. I’m not sure what they were talking about, but they are not happy with each other at the start of that event.”

“Oh, okay.”

Jonah wondered if he ought to give up on Lady Moss's invitation to go with them back to Chiswick and look at the photographs. Perhaps he needed to go find Lily Foster again, instead. He felt a nagging little feeling deep down that suggested her failure to tell him about her involvement in the Network and her meeting those murder victims might mean something darker than just not thinking it relevant to the investigation.

"Did you see if either of them had anything to do with any of the victims at the party?" he asked the reporter.

"Well, she was all over your brother," Keeley's words seemed to stab Jonah in the chest. There was another thing Lily hadn't mentioned. "And I did see her pictured with a few of the other victims, too. Most of the photos were of Lady Moss—"

"Reynolds always was a little obsessed," Jonah said.

"You should find Lily and ask what was going on at that event, four years ago. And why she's never said anything about all this."

"It does seem odd, but I never asked her about the Network before."

"A fight with her husband—well, he was the first victim of the Black Widow, right? So it could have been motive."

"I'm sure it's just one of those things, married couples and all that," Jonah took a deep breath. He didn't entirely like where Keeley was going with this—but he had to concede he had a personal bias regarding Lily Foster. He liked her too much, he trusted her too much. What if the reporter was barking up the right tree with this?

He said: "I saw Lily up in one of the rooms. Maybe she's still there, I could wait for her, ask her about all this."

Keeley said, "I'm heading to her place now. If she's still there at the event, that might be an advantage."

"An advantage?"

"I can give her house a little double-check."

“You’re going to break into her house?” Jonah felt frustration turn into irritation, though he knew Keeley was only doing what he felt was right. He should have known that working with a newspaper journalist meant playing with fire to some extent. But again, he had to accept that the reporter was more impartial than he was. Lily had failed to divulge all relevant information about her involvement with the murder victims. She only had herself to blame for that—and what if there was something relevant at her house, that he and Lily herself might have missed?

“It beats ransacking the bins, my friend. She needn’t know—we’ll just check on a few things. Make sure we’re not missing a trick.”

“Well, okay. I suppose she did let me look through her husband’s papers before—she might do again. If you find anything, just leave it there in the little study next to the bedroom. I can ask her for another look through Julian Foster’s things. Make it all legit.”

“Right you are. I’m sure there’ll be nothing. You just stay there, let me know if she leaves to head home.”

“I’m going to have to leave with Lady Moss and Reynolds any time soon.”

“Hmm. No problem. I’m in my car—I’ll get there before her even if she left now, I’ll have some time.”

“You sure you’re up to this after your miraculous escape from the Moss house?”

Keeley chuckled, “I’m okay. Just happy that nanny didn’t catch me. Found some interesting things in her little nanny pad—I don’t think I’d want to mess with her.”

“Interesting things?”

“Oh, you know, restraints, handcuffs, whips and chains.”

“Kinky.”

“Oh, she’s definitely a looker, but that’s not really my bag.”

Jonah laughed. “Do you get the feeling that Moss kid is going to grow up psychologically scarred?”

“He’ll probably rebel and become a monk.”

“Okay, I’ll try to find Lily Foster, see if I can keep her here a while. You get over to her place.”

“At least try to find out if she’s still there, or if she’s left,” Keeley said.

Eight

When he returned to the room where Emma had been with Lily before, neither of them were still there. The room had already been taken by another couple, although Jonah recognized some of the members of the audience had stayed.

Jonah cursed silently. Where had they gone? Was their evening over, or had they simply moved on to other things, other experiences? Was Emma still with Lily, or had they gone their separate ways? He had no way of telling.

He tapped out a brief text message to Keeley, warning him about Lily's disappearance, but the reporter said simply:

> Okay. Should have a little time anyway before she can get back from Richmond to Shepherd's Bush. See what I can do.

And then he heard a familiar voice behind him, and there was Lady Moss, followed by Reynolds and his camera as though she was some kind of celebrity with a paparazzo stalker.

"Ready to call it a night?" she said.

He had to believe that Mulray would keep an eye on Emma for the remainder of the night, she wouldn't leave her station until her amateur partner was safe and secure. Jonah needed to see those pictures on Lady Moss's computer.



"Everything okay?" Lady Moss said as they proceeded across the Thames over Kew Bridge in the big silver Mercedes.

“Mmm?”

“You’ve been very quiet since we left the party.”

“Oh, you know,” Jonah shrugged, “Lot to take in.”

“Quite an experience, huh?” she said, smiling and crossing her legs. She’d taken a shower up in that room after her little private time with Reynolds. On the way back to Chiswick, Jonah was occasionally afforded wafts of the clean floral accent from the body wash she’d used, though the car itself was a little overwhelmed by cologne worn by Reynolds, who was up in front driving. Sitting there next to him in that short white dress, the elegant blonde did now appear to be attempting to draw his eye again.

“I’ll say,” Jonah replied. “So if we weren’t leaving early, how long would all that continue?”

“All night. The hotel puts on a big brunch in the late morning—in that great hall, in fact, where all the dancing was. A lot of people will stay for that.”

“And when everybody goes... the wives won’t see the guys they’ve been with again, will they?”

“I couldn’t speak for anyone else,” Lady Moss said. “I was never one to form strong bonds with any of the men I’d sleep with at one of those events. It was always the more the merrier, as far as I was concerned.”

“Always moving on to the next guy, huh?”

She nodded. “Other women are different, though. Some women might well take a fancy to a nice young man they meet there. And if their husband likes that little added element to his jealousy from his wife taking a longer-term lover, perhaps they will start something.”

“So how did you meet your husband?” Jonah asked. “It was after you’d been with Reynolds a while?”

She nodded. “He bought my father’s company. Left my father there as chairman for a while...”

“And Reynolds was your boyfriend at the time?”

“First and foremost, he was my personal assistant. Behind the scenes, we’d been lovers for years, but we’d always kept it secret.”

“Father didn’t approve?”

“Something like that. Sometimes I think he bought that company just to set me up with a worthy man.”

“And Reynolds was happy for you to start seeing Lord Moss?”

“He always knew I was polyamorous,” she said, and sighed as she glanced out of the window at the forest of traffic heading toward Chiswick at little more than walking pace.

“Did your husband know you still had a boyfriend when you started seeing him?”

“I told Doug I was polyamorous during our first date,” she said, then laughed. “He was so very English about it—he blushed, but he was far too polite to be freaked out about it.”

“You didn’t worry about telling him?”

“Made no difference to me. I wanted him, sure. He was cute. He was an impressive businessman. But there were other men I could have easily enough.”

“So you usually tell guys you date about being polyamorous? Or at least, you did before you were married?”

She laughed, “Why not? If they’re freaked out, they’re probably lousy in bed anyway. A lot of them fuck me and think they’ll convert me, they’ll turn me into a good little Catholic wife or something.”

“But Douglas... your husband... must have accepted the idea, right?”

She smiled, “He was quiet at first. I knew how much he wanted to sleep with me, I thought he’d just try to ignore it. But then over dessert... well, he started asking about it.”

“You converted him.”

She shrugged. “He was curious. He’d never heard of it, he said. Beyond the whole Mormon thing with all those wives... then I guess as I told him more about it... well, it turned him on.”

“You told him about Reynolds?”

“Who do you think was the best man at our wedding? It was Douglas who decided to hire him as our personal servant.”

“You were alright about them marrying, Reynolds?” Jonah raised his voice to ask their driver.

The man was silent for a moment, before Lady Moss prompted, “You can answer him, darling.”

Reynolds said, “It wasn’t for me to decide, sir.”

“But you were okay about it? It even added to her attraction for you?”

The man nodded. “She knew how I felt about her, I knew how she felt about me. I didn’t have a problem with her loving someone else as well, if that’s what you mean, sir?”

Lady Moss said, “They accepted each other, and how I was with them both. But I don’t think they wanted me to consort with anyone else long-term.”

“And you were never tempted?”

She smiled, “Two men was enough for me to cope with. A husband and a servant. Another boyfriend would have been... tiresome.”

Jonah could see they were coming into Chiswick now, along the High Road. His thoughts were turning to where Keeley might be—whether he’d made it to Lily Foster’s house, whether he’d been able to break in. Then his thoughts were pulled back closer to home as he felt a hand touch down over his crotch.

“So do you think you’ll be wanting to attend those kind of events again?” Lady Moss said, almost purring as she stroked Jonah, his manhood

responding fairly quickly to her touch.

“I’m not sure,” he said. “Perhaps.”

“You looked as though you were enjoying what you saw.”

“It was... interesting. I suppose... I’d have to consider what part in it I’d want to play.”

“Whether to sleep around, or choose a favorite wife, you mean?”

“Or whether to be the one sleeping around, or the one bringing his wife to share,” Jonah said.

Lady Moss flashed her eyes at him. “Is there someone you have your eye on, young Mr Fielding?” she asked.

He smiled, “Someone.”

“And she knows that you’ve been... exploring... as part of your little investigation?”

“She does. And I’ve been... well, letting her explore.”

Lady Moss seemed very pleased with Jonah, as though she was a teacher, and he was her star pupil. “Well,” she said, her fingers closing around his shaft through the black worsted wool of his suit pants, “I’ll say whoever gets to call themselves Mrs Fielding some day is going to have a wonderful future ahead of her.”

Before she had a chance to unzip his fly, however, and do more than just caress his thickened cock, the Mercedes pulled up outside Lady Moss’s house.

“And here we are,” Lady Moss said. “Come on, I’ll show you up to the study so you can see those pictures.”



“Here...” said Lady Moss, hovering over his shoulder as he sat at the desk in her study, peering at the large, bright screen of the Macintosh computer. “Click on the Archive folder.”

Jonah clicked on the folder she pointed to, and inside were a great long list of other folders, each labeled by month and year. A few of the folders had only a year displayed as the label.

“These are the annual events,” she said.

“The Breeding Parties?”

“Uh-huh.”

Jonah clicked on one of these, the event from the previous year, rather than the event from four years ago. If Lily was put into suspicion by those particular images, he wanted to examine them himself, and not flag them up to Lady Moss just yet.

Inside the folder, individual photographs had been left with the automatic file name provided by the camera.

The first image was a woman lying on her back on a bed, surrounded by four men. She appeared to be laughing riotously, as she held one man’s erect cock, and no doubt enjoyed another inside her sex, though it was out of shot. The two other men fondled or kissed her breasts.

The next showed a woman with her wedding ring showing clearly on her finger as she went down on another woman, a young stud pounding into her from the rear. Limbs intruding into the shot suggested at least two other men were present in the scene.

The third on the pile revealed a woman on a bed, pressed up against some pillows, one muscular guy penetrating her missionary-style while she turned her head to take another man in her mouth.

“They’re explicit,” Jonah said.

“Of course.”

“It’s surprising that faces are visible. They’re clearly identifiable.”

Standing over him, Lady Moss nodded. “That’s part of the risk, and so the excitement for their husbands,” she said. “But they all know they’re perfectly safe. No one’s going to commit an indiscretion. If they did that, they wouldn’t be a part of the Network any more.”

Jonah smiled and looked up at her. “And I suppose no one could bring themselves to get thrown out of the network.”

The elegant blonde pushed out her chest, perhaps hoping he was getting back into the mood for a little something more. “Well now that you’re enjoying it, would you give it up?” she asked. “So much free sex with beautiful women?”

“I suppose not. And I suppose the wives and the husbands involved wouldn’t want to give it up either?”

She grinned, “They’re easier to trust. Since they’ve been part of the frivolities.”

Jonah flipped to another picture, this time showing a woman lying back with her head on a man’s naked lap, her face lodged up against his softening cock while another man lay on top of her, captured in mid-thrust. This time in the darkened background you could clearly see a whole host of suited men watching, probably including the husband.

“So if anyone accidentally let slip that something like this was going on...”

Lady Moss shrugged, “It would be denied, fairly strenuously. And the Network has the kind of people involved who can make anything go away.”

There were dozens of dozens of these pictures, showing scenes not too dissimilar to the party that evening, or some of the hotel encounters Jonah had experienced with other members of the Network. A few faces featured, Jonah even half-thought he recognized, somehow, though he couldn’t put any names to the faces.

Were some of these academics? The kind of respected fellows he knew from his studies, from his time at Oxford?

Lady Moss was watching him examine the pictures, enjoying how he was reacting to the scenes, which were frequently quite shocking, despite the clear style and affluence of those taking part.

So many husbands happy to see their beloved wives having fun with these young men, and quite obviously thrilled by their wives' public infidelity.

"I suppose it's one way to keep the excitement going in your marriage," he said, voicing his thoughts without particularly meaning to.

"And the bottom line is," Lady Moss said, subtly edging forward to nudge up against him, so that he couldn't fail but breathe her fragrance, and be reminded of her availability, "there's really nothing illegal going on here. It's just sex, consensual sex. A network of married couples having a little fun behind closed doors..."

"I suppose so."

And Jonah was finding himself becoming aroused, naturally. He could hardly avoid it, looking at so many scenes of pure erotic hedonism, while Lady Moss hovered over him.

Was she right, though? Was this Network completely unconnected to the murders? Just part of Nate's unorthodox dating history before his murder?

And what of those codes that were given out after events?

He turned his head to put the question to Lady Moss, only to find her stepping away, looking as though she was in need of a bathroom, perhaps.

"You don't mind if I..."

"Oh, of course."

She smiled, "I just have to sort out a few things with Reynolds before bed."

"No problem."

As she departed, he felt the air fizzing a little with the kind of tension that spoke of certainty that he was there to stay the night with her, and to make love to her.

For a few moments, he found himself flicking through the photographs without really looking at them. Thinking about Lady Moss, and Emma, and Lily, and even Mulray. So surprising that the Detective had been involved as Emma penetrated the Network herself. Would they come to the same conclusion, that none of this was relevant to the Black Widow murders?

He tried not to think of the paranoid thoughts about Emma and Clement—that Emma was now in the Network because she was pretending to be Clement's wife. That she wouldn't want to get kicked out of the Network, either, and so would want to stay with Clement.

He returned his focus to the photographs, and made his way to the folder containing images of the Network event held four years back.

Then after flicking through various images, he stopped on a picture of the back of a brunette woman riding a man on a bed full of other couples. He was certain he recognized her. He held it up, and underneath there was another picture of the same scene, from a different angle. It was unmistakably Lily Foster. And the man she was riding cowgirl style was quite clearly Nate. Shit.

Jonah's blood ran cold.

She'd always denied that she'd ever met Jonah's brother before. But in this photograph, Lily looked as though she was really into Nate as she rode him. Surely she wouldn't forget his face so readily? Perhaps Nate really had been one of a thousand lovers, though. She'd just forgotten him.

The faces of the suited men in the background were too unclear, the darkness too pervasive. Was Julian Foster present?

Jonah flicked through another couple of shots, and then there was another one, perhaps from the same party, perhaps from another since they were now on couches rather than a bed—Lily was lying on her back, being pounded by Nate with all explicit details right there for the

camera, while next to them another woman knelt between the legs of another young man, sucking on his cock.

Lily was looking up at Nate with adoring eyes.

Jonah felt the oxygen in that study thinning, his breathing becoming difficult. Had she lied to him about knowing Nate before? Why would she do that—unless she had something to hide?

Had Lily killed her husband, and then Lord Moss, and then Nate and the others? What was her motive? Something to do with the argument with her husband?

He couldn't quite believe what his eyes were telling him, but later in the stack, there was another shot of wives being wicked with younger men, and in the background Lily was there with Nate.

Then, he found himself looking at pictures of Lily clearly in conflict with her husband—Julian looking all kinds of angry as they discussed something in rather too public a manner.

All kinds of questions were swirling around Jonah's head. But despite the maelstrom of confusion, he had one underlying clear thought: Lily had questions to answer. He wasn't yet willing to admit that she might have purposefully deceived him, that there might be something dark within her, some kind of guilt. But she definitely knew something she hadn't revealed.

He paused to check he couldn't hear Lady Moss returning. There was only silence. Nervous, but calm, he sneaked his mobile phone out of his pants pocket, turned it on, and tapped on the camera app.

Would Lady Moss have him expelled from the Network for copying these pictures? Even merely with a phone camera? Perhaps, if she discovered him. But if the Network was only a coincidence—the place, perhaps, where Lily Foster met her victims, but not the actual cause of the murders—then it was no longer necessary to be in the Network, was it?

Quickly, he snapped a few shots of the pictures in which Lily and Nate featured, and some in which the other murder victims appeared—then

some of the images showing Lily's argument with her husband.

Well, it wasn't as though Lady Moss would have him searched on his way out, was it?



He looked up from the desk to see Lady Moss walk back in, only now she wasn't wearing her dress, or any of the clothes she'd been wearing at the party.

She quite took the breath away.

"What do you think?" she smiled, putting one of her bare feet up on the glass coffee table a few yards away from Jonah and the desk. "Still got it?"

Jonah nodded, and he did feel himself stiffening at the sight of the ravishing naked blonde, but at the same time he felt the cold claw of fear clutching at his heart. If she knew he'd been copying the pictures in any way, she might not be so warm toward him.

"You look incredible," he said, unfastening a couple of buttons as though to distract her from the fact that his phone was still sitting out on the desk on top of the photographs.

She stood there, smiling in delight at his response while she ran her fingers lightly over her body and her thighs, and she didn't seem to have noticed the phone, or if she had, she hadn't connected it with the ability to take unauthorized snapshots of the pictures.

Without even tearing his eyes away from her, he was able to take his phone and slip it into a pocket, then shuffle the stack of photographs into a more orderly pile.

Lady Moss slowly walked toward him, a leopard on the prowl.

She leaned over the desk, giving him a superlative view of her cleavage as well as a fresh chestful of her scent. She said, "Anything interesting in those pictures?"

"A few things," he said.

"Like?"

"When I've seen wives through the Network, I end up being given a little card with letters on it."

"I'm not sure that's really my area."

"But you know it happens? There's nothing like that at any of the larger events, the Breeding Party. Tonight, or in any of these pictures."

"No."

"You know what it is? The letters could be a stock code..."

Lady Moss shrugged, "Some kind of sponsorship, I was always led to believe. Conferences have sponsorship these days, don't they? Advertising. You think it might be connected to the killings?"

"I don't know. Perhaps, perhaps not."

"You see anything suspicious in the pictures?"

He sighed. "I saw my brother in some of them."

"Your brother?"

"I guess he was involved in the Network after all."

Lady Moss looked at him with sympathy, though also perhaps solidarity. She said, "I'm sure it wasn't anything to do with his death."

Jonah nodded. "It just might be where the killer found her victims."

"I suppose that's possible," she said. "You think I should give these pictures to the police? I'm not sure I'd be allowed..."

She showed a note of fear at the prospect of giving up the pictures to the authorities. Perhaps the Network was nothing to do with the deaths itself, but it would take action against Lady Moss for betraying its secrets.

“We could tell my friend, she’s very discreet. She could take a look at these.”

He reached up to hold her head in both hands, to kiss her lips. To run his fingers through her silky hair.

“Your friend, the one at tonight’s event?”

“You saw her?”

Lady Moss smiled, “She was a little obvious.”

Jonah said, “The woman with my brother...” He picked up the picture to show her. “You know her? She was there at the party, you know.”

She squinted at the picture, “I thought I recognized her... she was with that blonde, early on...”

“It’s Lily Foster. Wife of—”

“Julian Foster, yes, of course she is. I should have known. I remember seeing her picture in the papers, although it was a while ago. Looks like she was friendly with your brother.”

“In the other pictures, too. She told me she’d never met him.”

Lady Moss nodded. “It is hard to keep track, sometimes. All the men we see. Especially after time has passed...”

Jonah said, “I’ll just have to ask her again. I’m not sure I trust her, though. Do you know when these events were, this one from these pictures?”

She shrugged, “That one was a few years ago, I think. There was this almighty argument when the night came to a close—I remember that. One of the wives was very upset, from what I remember. It happens occasionally, though it’s more usual for the husband to snap. Come on. All that can wait until morning, right?”

She kissed him, and pulled him up from the chair.



Jonah was a little distracted as she dragged him into the master bedroom, the door closing firmly behind them. His thoughts were running away from him. After the night he'd had, the thought of being shut in a room with a naked Lady Moss for the night was almost overwhelming.

As she stripped him, Jonah lay back and just allowed her to do as she wished with him. He was thinking about how Lily could have fooled him for so long, how she could have been so sweet with him while lying the whole time.

Why would she lie like that, unless she had something to hide?

Could she conceivably be a killer?

What motive would she have?

As he lifted his hips to allow his wealthy widow of a lover to remove his pants, the burning memory of Emma and her room full of men returned to him. The way she'd focused affectionate attention on her fake husband had made him feel worse than the fact that she had been fucked hard by three different men at once.

What if Lily had been focusing too much attention on Nate that night? The pictures all showed her with him, and with no other men during that whole event.

What if her feelings for Nate had been more than just a woman enjoying a particular man for a night's carnal entertainment? And what if Julian had objected to it?

"Here," said Lady Moss, "I want you to try something..."

Naked, on his back, he didn't even react as Lady Moss produced a white silk scarf, and brought it down over his eyes. If she'd wanted to kill him,

why wait until he was in her own home? She could have done it back at the Breeding Party in one of a hundred rooms, and remained completely anonymous. He lifted his head off the mattress to help her tie it around him.

With both hands tied to the bed, he felt the wonderful warm, smooth skin of Lady Moss as she climbed onto him, straddling his waist.

She touched his lower lip with her finger, kissed him softly just below it, then licked his lips, his face. He smelled her perfume, the Champagne on her warm breath. She started lightly kissing his chest, running her fingers lightly over it, her silky hair trailing over his skin.

“Feel good?”

“Uh-huh.”

The blindfold really did enhance his senses, the experience of her draping her stunning body all over him. He felt her tongue, her nose, her lips trailing over his stomach, and then moments later she was up by his head again, kissing and licking his face. Playing with him, treating him like some kind of toy, some kind of treat.

Then he breathed in a stronger hint of her perfume, and the hot, velvet flesh of her breast touched against his face, her hard nipple placed between his lips. He took it into his mouth, sucked on her, brushing his tongue over her sensitive little bud to ease out a long sigh.

“It takes a certain amount of trust, doesn’t it?” Lady Moss said, amused.

“I guess so.”

“I really could do anything to you right now.”

He felt her maneuvering over him, one leg nudging up against the side of his head, the mattress depressed by her weight. He smelled something different in the air, something familiar, but disrupting the pureness of her perfume.

Then it wasn’t her breast she was touching gently over his lips, but the tender lips of her pussy. And she was dripping wet.

Lady Moss almost purred as Jonah craned his neck to run his tongue along her slippery folds. She tasted delicious. Pressing her body down on him, riding his mouth, Jonah adored hearing her cry out at his touch, at his tongue squirming inside her, at his unbridled hunger for her tangy juices.

Shackled, used by this beautiful woman, Jonah couldn't see her as any kind of threat, certainly not a killer. Was his lust affecting his judgment? Would it be the same if ever he did meet the Black Widow?



As she dismounted, he found that he missed the heat of her body over his face, the air suddenly cold on him now that he was coated in her wetness. How exquisite it had been to serve her, though, and to taste her on his lips still.

“Mmm... you are quite something.”

“I’m really only lying here,” he said.

“You’re far too modest.”

He heard the mattress creak as she clambered back onto the bed, and then felt her gloriously soft skin again as she straddled his thighs. Then he felt her pouring an ice-cold liquid onto his bare chest—oil of some description, he guessed. It smelled gently floral.

“I feel like you need rewarding,” she laughed, placing her hands on his chest, splaying out her fingers, spreading the oil over his skin.

Eyes still veiled by the white scarf, he felt her slowly lie on him, her breasts touching down on his chest, her body hot as she came to rest over him, sliding over him, oiled up just as he was.

It felt nice, rubbing against her. Then she was moving down, her hair trailing over his loins, her lips dancing over his shaft, her tongue emerging to lash his sensitive cock. As she took his tip inside her hot

mouth, Jonah wondered if Reynolds had quietly entered the room, if he was now watching this. There was nothing stopping him. Wouldn't Lady Moss want him there?

"You think you'll ever get married?" she asked him.

She held the base of his cock tight in her fingers, and licked his shaft again, reveling in this stranger's cock being in her hands. Making Jonah more certain that her constant companion must also be in the room.

"Probably," he said as she gently squeezed and pumped his shaft, the oil making her fingers slip over him in a wonderfully sensual manner.

"You think you'll be a one-woman man?"

"For the right woman."

Jonah let out a long groan as she sank down on him again, slow, forceful, sucking him as she took a surprising amount of his length inside her mouth.

"And would the woman you marry have to be yours alone?" Lady Moss asked him.

Now he felt the cold oil poured over his cock, and it made him flinch.

"It would depend... on what she wanted..."

Lady Moss chuckled, "And if she wanted you to share her?"

"Then I suppose I'd have to let her."

He groaned again as she started pumping him with both hands, and then slipped his hardness between her breasts to use her cleavage to rub him.

"I think she'll be a very lucky girl, whoever she turns out to be."

Jonah felt her straddle his thighs, and as she continued to pump his oiled cock in her hands, now she was pressing it up against her sex. God, it felt amazing.

When she sat on him, his cock pinched between her labia yet not penetrating her, the oil aiding her in sliding up and down his length, it was so intense he nearly lost it once again. She was so tight around him, the oil and her profuse wetness making him glide inside her.

Then her gasps and sighs steadily turned into whimpers and cries as she bounced on him. He felt her shaking, imagined that she was flickering a hand over her clit as she fucked him, aiding her passage to Heaven and back.

He could hear her lean back, her head tilted up, the sound suddenly seeming more distant as she yelled out, a great orgasmic scream.

Jonah felt her pussy contracting as she shook from the energy of her climax sweeping through her body, his rock-hard shaft was being squeezed in pulses. It meant he had no chance whatsoever of escaping without giving her all he had.

He felt the pressure rising between his legs, the euphoria reaching incredible heights—and then he went through the point of no return. Felt his hot come welling up, only to burst forth deep inside her as she came to a crashing halt on top of him.

When she removed his blindfold, holding the back of his neck as she kissed his mouth, he sat up to find that the door to the room was open a foot or two. It made him certain that Reynolds had been watching. He didn't mind, though.



“Y ou’re thinking about those pictures?”

They were lying together, catching their breath. Lady Moss propped herself up on her elbow, looking down on him as he lay slumped against the pillows.

“Is it obvious?”

She smiled. “I can see you thinking about it all, in your eyes.”

“I guess I need to feel... I’m making progress.”

“You need to have fun as well, you know. I’m sure if he could know what you were doing, your brother would be proud of you. But he’d want you to enjoy yourself as well.”

Jonah shrugged.

“You talked about an argument at that event a few years ago,” he said.

“Yes, I did.”

“Can you remember anything more about it? Did you see who was involved?”

“I don’t remember much. I think she had dark hair. She was wearing a red dress...”

Jonah flinched. Lily had been wearing red in those pictures. “Might it have been the woman we saw tonight, Lily Foster? She was arguing with her husband?”

“It’s possible.”

“What if she was arguing with her husband—with Julian Foster—over which man she was with that night?”

“It’s an unspoken rule on one of those events,” Lady Moss said, “that the wife chooses which men she wants. The husband doesn’t get a say. It’s part of the risk for the husband of taking her—part of the fun.”

“So maybe she chose a man who made Julian feel threatened.”

“Your brother?”

“That’s what I’m thinking.”

“You know, ever since that night, the Network’s employed a security man to mix with the guests,” she said.

“It must have taken Julian by surprise—he’d done so much with Lily, tried all kinds of things with her and other men, other couples. And suddenly she’s with this one guy, and he can’t handle it.”

“It happens.”

“Did it ever happen with you?”

“I don’t think so. I never really went for anyone for more than a quick tumble, other than Reynolds and Doug, of course. They were both fine about each other from the start.”

“Julian Foster probably wasn’t quite like them.”

“It’s more common to accept another man fucking your wife, but less so accepting another man loving your wife,” Lady Moss said.

“Julian might have wanted to explore everything this kind of fantasy had to offer, but maybe he couldn’t handle it when Lily finally found someone else who claimed her heart.”

“Seems like it, doesn’t it? It’s often what happens when husbands fall off the Network.”

He felt the pretty blonde’s fingers brush lightly against his manhood, and it surprised him by stirring strongly. This incredible night still had life left in it yet.

It was almost enough to keep him from wondering what was happening to Emma following her public session fucking three men at once.



Jonah woke too early for the sun to be dispelling any of the night’s darkness just yet.

Lady Moss was still sleeping next to him on that enormous bed. Lying on her front, the bedsheets covering very little of her, her hair flowing all

around her, she almost tempted him to try waking her again for a little more indulgence. But he wanted to look at more of those pictures—and, if he could, to find and censor the images of Emma that Reynolds had taken that evening.

He was shivering as he stepped out of bed. Lady Moss might be wealthy, but her house could have done with a little more heating at night. It made him grab his clothes before escaping the bedroom to find the study.

Dressed, he felt safer. He could tell himself that Lady Moss had said he would be able to look at her pictures in the morning. She didn't need to know about wanting to delete pictures of Emma.

It was a huge relief to find the camera sitting there on the desk where the butler had left it. He still had to dress in double-quick time, but then he was able to switch it on, and find the right buttons to access the pictures already taken.

It was an even bigger relief to get through to the right part of the previous night's event, and actually press the delete button on the images that showed Emma's face. There were quite a few, but perhaps not so many as there might have been—Reynolds as the cameraman was still too interested in Lady Moss. There were almost more pictures of her reacting to Emma's debauchery as of Emma's debauchery itself.

Then he came to the images capturing later on in the evening, and found to his amusement that Reynolds had been taking pictures while Lady Moss had been playing with him in the bedroom, with him blindfolded and tied to the bed. It was interesting to see the whole scene from the butler's perspective. But he didn't need to delete these pictures: one of the positives of having that blindfold in place was that it meant he wasn't identifiable.

But as he did one final check to make sure Emma's future modesty might be protected, he felt a buzz from his pocket—his phone.

He retrieved it, only to find 14 missed calls and a string of messages. His heart sank—what had he missed while he'd been distracted by the charms of Lady Moss?

The most recent text message was from Mulray:

>Call me soon as you get this. Your reporter friend was killed last night.

Nine

He called Mulray from the study, not particularly worried if anyone should find him there. He needed a quiet space away from the sleeping Lady Moss, and the study offered just that.

“He was hit by a car on the Uxbridge Road,” Mulray said, her voice calm but concerned. Jonah felt as though his insides had been minced. He might not have known Keeley particularly well, but it had been well enough. It brought back the sharp pain of loss he’d felt when he’d learned that Nate had gone.

Death was such an amorphous thing when it happened to people you didn’t know. It was something the mind could safely package away as being not relevant, nothing to be directly affected by. But when it happened to someone you knew, it was suddenly so real. Keeley had been a living, breathing human being. He hadn’t always done things the way Jonah would have wanted, but he’d been a good guy. And young—far too young to lose the rest of his days.

“When was it?” Jonah managed to utter the words.

“A little past 3am. Hit and run, it seems.”

“I’m sorry I had my phone switched off—I was with Lady Moss. I had no idea that anything—”

“It’s okay. It’s good we can easily rule you out of our inquiries. But your phone was the last one he called.”

And then he was killed. Just like that. Gone. Jonah felt sick.

“We were working on something together,” he said, and it dawned on him that what he and Keeley had been working on was about to come out into the fresh air. Should he hide it? Their cooperation in the breaking and entering of two homes that night?

Jonah suddenly felt a chill shoot down his spine. He could easily be arrested for what they'd done.

"Can I ask what?"

Jonah swallowed. "He was going to Lily Foster's house," he said, silently cursing for being so stupid as to get involved in bending—or breaking, more like—the law in order to further his personal investigation. "He wanted to find out about her involvement with the Network."

"At 3am?"

Mulray's sharp question correctly highlighted the absurdity of it all.

Jonah felt the natural urge to deny, to cover up, to conceal. To flee all this, and find some safe little hole in which to cower. He sighed. "I was looking through some photos that Lady Moss has showing previous Network events," he said. "There were pictures from an event four years ago that suggested all of the victims of the Black Widow were there."

"At the same event?"

"Yes. And Lily was there with all of them. We... well, he was certain that since she'd never mentioned any of that before, it meant she was guilty."

"So he went to confront her?"

Jonah felt acid eating through his stomach wall, knowing it was because he was twisting the facts to conceal their wrongdoing. But while it might make him a coward, if he was in jail for perverting the course of justice or conspiracy to break into someone's house, or whatever the charges might be, there was no way he'd be able to continue investigating his brother's murder.

"I don't know. I mean, he was going over there... I told him not to. I told him it was probably nothing—she never talked to me about the Network because I never really asked her about it."

Mulray suddenly cut in, reassuring. "I don't think it was Lily, Jonah," she said. Her voice was instantly soothing. "I saw her go home with Emma."

“After 3am?”

“I’m not sure. I think it was a little before that, but even so.”

“So if she does have anything to do with all this, now Emma is with her?”

Jonah felt the sting of regret, that he hadn’t listened to Keeley, hadn’t jumped the first time there was even the whiff of suspicion on Lily Foster, since Emma had been spending so much time with her that evening. Putting herself in danger, no matter how unwitting.

What if Emma had learned something about Lily that night, that made her become a threat to Lily’s freedom?

“Have you called Emma since you saw her leave?” Jonah asked the detective.

“No. Have you?”

“No.”

“I’ll get over there now,” Mulray sighed. “Look, whatever all this is, we’ll figure it out.”

Jonah said: “I’m on my way, too.”

He hung up the phone, and instantly dialed Emma. Then, when she didn’t answer, he tried Lily Foster. She didn’t answer, either.



Lady Moss was sympathetic when he woke her, told her that a friend had died. She offered him breakfast, a shower, some clean clothes, and Reynolds was standing by to assist if any assistance was needed. But he politely declined, exiting as speedily as he could.

He hailed a taxi on the Chiswick High Road, which would give him an awful 20 minutes or so to think about what was going on, and what kind of danger Emma might be in.

It was a minute or so before he thought of going through his missed calls and text messages.

Three missed calls had come from Mulray later that morning—the remainder were from Keeley. He hadn't left voicemail messages, but there were texts. Most of them were asking where he was, urging him to call. One of them, though, made Jonah catch his breath as he read:

>Found something. Julian Foster took a paternity test. Came back negative. That mean his kid isn't really his kid?

Lily and Julian's child was, what, three years old? A little more than three? Could he have been conceived around the same time Lily and Julian had that big argument? If Lily had been pregnant by another man, perhaps Julian couldn't handle it.

That might explain the argument from that night of the Network event four years back, but Julian Foster's death—and the first of the Hotel Killings—had only been a year or so before. Lily couldn't have killed her husband over an argument that happened years ago, surely?

The logic gave Jonah some reassurance that Emma would be safe when he arrived in Shepherd's Bush, but he didn't like the way more and more dark secrets were emerging from Lily Foster's past.

And as the taxi drove on up Goldhawk Road, Emma still wasn't answering her phone.



There were police cars surrounding a white tent on the side of Uxbridge Road as Jonah's taxi approached the turn up to Stanlake Road, with plenty of crime scene tape to cordon off the area, though traffic was still

flowing along the busy Uxbridge Road itself. It made Jonah shiver to see the place where Keeley had been knocked down.

Surely it could be no coincidence, that he was hunting a murderer, and then he himself was killed? Jonah didn't believe in coincidences.

If the Black Widow herself had done it, then Lady Moss couldn't be the Black Widow since she had been in bed with Jonah at the time. Oh, she might have managed some clever little ploy to fuck him, then drug him so she could leave and bump off the reporter. But how had she known Keeley would be there in Shepherd's Bush trying to break into Lily Foster's house?

As the taxi turned up Stanlake Road, Jonah also found himself hoping that he would arrive to find Emma alive and well, with Lily Foster exonerated for Keeley's death by the fact that Emma had been with her all night.

Oh, but the Black Widow could have had an accomplice. In fact, Jonah had come to strongly believe she did—if she was a shared wife, sleeping with the kind of traders who slept with shared wives, there would be a husband. So no one could truly be exonerated for Keeley's death, even if they had an alibi.

Mulray's car and a police squad car sat parked outside Lily's house as Jonah drew up. He felt optimism that there weren't more police cars, and perhaps a police van to take her in under high security as the suspected Black Widow killer. But the presence of the marked police car unnerved him.

He paid off the taxi driver with a hefty tip, since he didn't want to wait for change.

The front door of Lily Foster's house opened as Jonah arrived, and it made his heart jump: were they bringing Lily out after all? Had she done something awful to Emma as well?

But it was only Mulray and an accompanying woman police officer.

Mulray nodded, attempting to reassure him. "They're okay," the detective said. "Both of them."

Relief surged through his veins.

“And you’ve talked to Lily?” he asked.

Mulray nodded. “She’s admitted she has more to tell us about her involvement with the Network—and that event four years ago. But I don’t think any of it makes her a murderer.”

Jonah let out a long, slow breath.

He wasn’t impartial when it came to Lily Foster. But it had to mean something, that he couldn’t bring himself to believe she was a killer.

“We’ll need you to come in some time, help us understand what Keeley might have been getting himself into before he died.

“Of course,” he said.

Mulray touched his shoulder, offering him her sympathy. “Get some sleep first, huh?” she said.

He nodded.

Then Lily Foster’s front door opened again, and Jonah was a little startled as Emma emerged, still halfway through putting on her coat. She was wearing jeans now, her hair still a little damp from a recent shower.

“Hey,” she smiled, genuinely pleased to see him.

Jonah felt his heart squeezed by the crush he had on her. A crush, he now viewed it as, since he couldn’t be with her any more, since he had no indication she wanted to come back to him.

“Hey,” he said. “You okay?”

She nodded. “The Detective offered me a lift home,” she said, then laughed, “Need to get some sleep.”

Standing there before her, Jonah felt his thick cock throbbing in his pants, from the vision of beauty she presented now, even without makeup and wearing clothes that could only have been borrowed from Lily, and the memory of scandalous things she’d got up to the night before.

“You look like you could do with some shut-eye yourself,” she said, her smile melting into a look of concern for him.

“Yeah, I guess so.”

“I’m sorry to hear what happened to that reporter. You liked him.”

“He was a good guy, underneath it all,” Jonah nodded.

Emma leaned in and kissed his cheek, the scent of floral shampoo filling his chest as she stepped up to him. “I’ll see you soon?”

“Whenever you like,” he replied, feeling a little powerless.

“We have to figure out what’s next, don’t we?” she said, and he wasn’t sure if she meant the investigation, or their relationship. He rather suspected she merely meant the investigation.

He said, “I guess so. First, I have to talk to Lily about what she knows about the Network.”

Emma nodded. “You saw some pictures of her. She told me about it, you know. About being part of it all.”

“She knew my brother.”

“And a couple of the other traders,” Emma said. “She didn’t know them particularly well—just sleeping partners, really. Didn’t think it was important.”

He nodded, and glanced down at the street to see the white police car moving away, and Mulray climbing into her blue Ford. “I don’t think she had anything to do with any of the murders,” he said. “I just... I want to find out if she knew anything else.”

Emma took a pace back, and down one of the steps to the street. “I can see why you like her,” she said, and for one agonizing moment Jonah felt as though Emma had given up on him because of how he felt about Lily. And that now she was sure of it, that she couldn’t be with him.

How could he make her understand? He liked Lily, but he didn’t love her.

Somehow, pride and exhaustion and shock conspired to withdraw his ability to voice his thoughts.

“See you soon,” she said, and he watched her climb into the passenger seat of Mulray’s car, before the detective drove away.



Emma had left the front door open for him to step inside, the warmth and the familiarity of the house seemed comforting to him, somehow, after the horror of learning of Keeley’s fate.

It took a moment for his eyes to get used to the gloom as the door closed behind him, a moment to spot the presence of Lily Foster hovering at the top of the stairs wearing a white negligee.

“Hey,” she said. “How are you, Jonah?”

Would she be angry at him for doubting her, for imagining that she might be a murderer? He couldn’t be sure how much she knew.

“So-so,” he said, pausing with one foot up on the second step.

“I’m sorry about your friend,” she said. She looked beautiful, as ever, her elegant form poised against the bannister up there, her wispy nightwear offering hints of her curves beneath, her long reddish-brown hair dropping down her back, her pretty face very lightly flushed.

Jonah looked up, and tried to hold back his desire for her. What if Keeley’s last actions had uncovered something about her? And that was why he was killed?

“He came here before he died,” he said now, taking a step up. Feeling it was wrong to hide anything, if he was annoyed at her for hiding things from him.

“Here? I must have been still at the party,” she said, calm, not seeming in any way guilty. And he didn’t think she was one for acting.

“He broke in,” Jonah said, continuing slowly up the stairs toward her. “I knew he was going to try it, that he wanted to look through your things.”

“Did he find what he was looking for?” Lily seemed ultimately calm, and Jonah felt surprised, even disappointed by her reaction.

“You’re not angry?”

“Should I be?” she said, and as he approached her, he could smell the characteristic citrus-floral accent of her Chanel No 5.

“He broke into your home. And I didn’t stop him,” he said.

“I’m sure he had a good reason,” Lily said. “He probably could have waited an hour or two, and I could have saved him the trouble of picking my lock.”

She took a step back as Jonah arrived at the top of the stairs, and it seemed suddenly inviting to him. She seemed to want him, even if he had been party to a break-in at her home.

“We found some pictures of you,” he said, taking another step to her. “At another Network event, four years ago.”

She nodded, her dark brown eyes flicking between his. “Detective Mulray mentioned them,” she said quietly. “But you know I was going to tell you about all that?”

“You didn’t.”

“I thought we would get more time together. Your girlfriend stopped all that when she scared you away.”

“But now she’s with you, and not me,” Jonah said, trying not to let his inner anger show.

Lily smiled faintly, “She’s very sweet. She wanted to know why you kept coming back to me.”

“And you showed her?”

“She couldn’t get enough, as it turns out.”

Jonah pulled her to him, unable to resist himself, but now feeling an added draw to the older brunette. He touched his face to her cheek, and then slid down to taste her neck.

Under the scent of her Chanel No 5, he could detect the faint spice of female arousal about Lily's skin. Emma.

He felt his whole body tremble with need.

"You were with her when Keeley died," he said.

She nodded, her hand sliding up his chest. "I'm not sure what time we got back. We collapsed in bed for a few hours, but she was up again as soon as it was light again. She has a lot of energy, that one."

The sparks in Lily's eyes attested to what must have gone on between the two women in this very house.

Jonah turned her face to his, closing his mouth over hers, tasting Emma's own personal flavor on her lips. It drove him wild for a few moments, and he was sucking on her lips, delving his tongue gently into her mouth. Experiencing Emma's own arousal by proxy.

"She must be driving you crazy," Lily whispered, breathless. "Holding you off like she is."

"She told you about it?"

Lily nodded. "She said she was only doing it because she was forced to. That there was some reason behind it."

"Maybe she'd slept with my brother too? And didn't want to tell me."

Lily stepped back, conceding her failure to tell him everything. "I didn't mean to lie," she said. "I just... I found it difficult to tell you about that. I was worried it might mean... you might not want to spend time with me."

Jonah stepped up to her again. "I enjoy spending time with you," he said. "Just because you were close with my brother, that wouldn't put me off."

She kissed him, and this time his hand slipped under the thin white material of her negligee, taking in the wonderful smooth softness of her

skin, cupping her breast. Her nipples were stiff, even before he began to gently squeeze them.

“How well did you know him?” he asked her.

“Not much. When Julian was invited to join the Network, he was one of the first young men to spend an evening with us,” she said. “He came to see us a few times after that, but it was really only sex.”

She pushed him back against the bannister as they continued to suck on each others’ faces, and her hand came to explore the form of his hardness through his suit pants.

“You were at another Breeding Party four years ago,” he said, wanting to just let go, but feeling the unanswered questions getting in the way.

“Yes. Probably.”

“In the pictures, it looked like you were having a fight with your husband.”

“Ah yes, the fight,” she grinned, and pulled away from him, grabbing his hand to lead him toward the bedroom. “That would have been over your brother, actually.”

“My brother?”

“Julian was getting the wrong vibes from him, I guess.”

“The wrong vibes?”

“I suppose I was getting a little too cozy with him,” she said. “It was still fairly early on in our dealing with the Network.”

“He told you not to see Nate any more?”

“Something like that,” she said, pushing Jonah back and down onto the bed. “I told him he was being ridiculous—I did want to go on seeing Nate, that was true.”

“So what happened at the Breeding Party?”

She knelt on the bed next to him, brushed her hair out of her face and kissed him again. “I got very drunk,” she said, before kissing him again, “and slept with rather a lot of men.”

“And did any of those men... end up as victims of the Black Widow?”

She shrugged. “I’m sorry. I didn’t tell you about any of them because I simply don’t remember who they were. As I said, I was rather drunk—and there were rather a lot of them that night.”

Jonah held her, and turned her over, almost taking charge. “So you don’t remember their faces. But one of them got you pregnant, right?”

Lily quietly gasped, her eyes widening in genuine surprise. “Heavens, wherever did you get that idea?”

“Keeley said he found a paternity test your husband took, and it was negative,” he said.

“So you think he wasn’t Aaron’s father?” The sharp note in Lily’s voice was almost enough to make him sure all this was wrong, somehow. It seemed to come as some relief to Jonah, though he couldn’t entirely explain why. He wanted to believe that Julian had not had to face the reality that his beloved son was not his own.

“So the test wasn’t about Aaron?”

“God, no. But Julian did sleep with someone that night, though it’s not the usual thing for a husband at one of those Breeding Parties. He was angry at me, I suppose. Tempted by some rich blonde or other.”

Jonah felt a warm glow of relief and desire inside. And it was only tempered by the sudden sense that this was all a dead end—that while it might leave Lily in the clear, it left the investigation with no obvious leads.

He kissed his way down Lily’s chest, brushing over the thin semi-sheer material of her nightwear, and he could swear he detected the slight hint of coconut—Emma’s signature scent. It only fired him up further.

He pushed up her negligee as he came down to lie between her thighs, revealing the tidy dark patch of down over her mound, and the delights of her sex beneath.

“I told you Julian occasionally slept with other women, back in those days?” she said. “And maybe he did again, after Aaron came along.”

Jonah planted kisses along her thighs, breathing in her arousal, gazing up at her inviting pussy.

“So the paternity test, it was to do with one of those women?”

“Had to be.”

She cried out as he sank onto her tender folds, devouring her hungrily.

If the investigation was to go back to square one, he might as well enjoy the fringe benefits, he figured.

Ten

There was a knock on the door, and Jonah jumped up to get it. Despite the comfort from knowing the evening's date already, he was nervous as he went to admit her into the room.

He received a slight jolt to open the door to reveal a beautiful brunette standing there in the hallway—and was confused for a moment before he recognized her. Jessica had changed her hair color.

“Hi,” he said, stepping back to let her past.

“Hello, Robert.”

She was wearing a black raincoat, which fell down to cover her thighs, but had enough buttons unfastened to expose her ample cleavage. Her chocolate-brown hair fell to the middle of her back, loose waves that had once been blonde.

She breezed past him, her same exotic perfume filling his chest as she went by. He shivered. She looked even more formidable with dark hair.

“It’s been a while, she said, turning to him.

Jonah stepped up, replied, “I’ve been busy, I guess...”

She nodded, made a slight movement aside, then pointed to the bed, giving him a silent order to sit there. “You know that’s not good enough, I trust?”

He stuttered, “I know.”

“What do you have for me?”

She leaned over him, her small but uplifted breasts on show thanks to her low neckline, and placed the tips of her fingers on his crotch, feeling out the outline of the hardness within his pants.

“Good,” she said, leaning down further, stroking him.

She moved over him, crawling onto the bed, her fingers rising to his chest to push him flat on the mattress. “That’s something, I suppose. But you know I’m going to have to punish you for leaving it so long.”

“Yes, Miss.”

She rolled over and off him, then slapped his cock, and jumped back up to her feet there in front of him.

“Stand up.” She said, and he instantly complied. “Take off my coat.”

He reached under her breasts, and began unfastening the rest of the buttons on her coat. He found himself wondering where Jessica’s boyfriend or husband was just then—waiting for her in another room in the hotel? Or had she been cruel to him and left him at home? He’d feel bad for the guy, except that he probably got off on having a wife or girlfriend treat him that way.

Made Jonah think of Reynolds, Lady Moss’s manservant. He had stood by while his love had not only seduced another man but married him, had his child. Reynolds, like Jessica’s partner, wasn’t so different in age from Jonah—was this how his own dark fantasies were progressing?

“Put it somewhere,” she said as he helped her remove her coat. He hung it over one of the chairs that sat around the little dining table in the corner of the suite.

Under her coat, Jessica was wearing some kind of corset that squeezed in her waist and pushed up her chest to provide cleavage he’d never thought possible from someone of her shape. It held up her stockings with suspenders—she looked phenomenal.

He stepped up to her again, and found his hands moving to her breasts without even thinking about it.

“Don’t touch me until I give you permission,” she said, stopping him in his tracks.

“No, Miss.”

“You are going to do what you’re told tonight, aren’t you?”

“Yes, Miss.”

She stroked a rogue strand of her dark hair back out of her face, behind an ear. “You better do, if you want to fuck me.”

She edged closer to him, her face so close he could feel her hot breath on his lips. “You do want to fuck me, don’t you?”

He trembled a little. “Yes, Miss.”

She whispered, “You want to put that cock in my hot pussy?” Then she grabbed his stiffness, stroked him. “You want to slide that thing in my mouth?”

“Mm-hmm.”

“Well, you’d better make sure I’m taken care of if you want any of that.”

“Yes, Miss.”

She kissed his mouth, sucking on his lower lip as she continued to stroke his manhood. Any thoughts of Jessica’s partner, or Reynolds, or any other man, evaporated from Jonah’s head—after how she’d used him on their other two dates, he really did want some closure here, he was desperate to fuck her.

“Down on your knees,” she said crisply, stepping back from him, the backs of her thighs touching the mattress.

He did as he was told, slumping down onto his haunches.

Jessica put one foot up onto the bed. She didn’t need to give him the order, just one movement of her eyes told him what she wanted.

He kissed the top of her foot, just under the buckle of her high-heeled shoe, then slowly made his way up her leg, brushing his lips and his nose over the black nylon of her stocking, breathing in her fragrance, and the faint but growing scent of her excitement.

He could hear her breathing deepen as he kissed his way along her thigh, and neared her sex, her spicy fragrance becoming intense. When he arrived at her panties, he found them semi-transparent and wet with her juices.

Her hand spread over his head as he ran his tongue over her soaking panties, tasting her, familiarizing himself with her tangy flavor again.

“Do it,” she hissed, her grip tightening on his head, pressing him against her, her hips now moving slightly to grind against his face.

He moaned, and she said, “You like that, huh? You like my sweet pussy?”

He moaned again, and for a moment or two she seemed to get a little carried away enjoying him, using him.

But then she sighed, and pushed him away. “I like that,” she said. “Now take my panties off.”

She allowed him to remove the little scrap of black material, peeling it over her delectable rear, groaning as he leaned in to steal little licks of her pussy while she stepped out of her cast off underwear. Then she sat, lay back on the bed, spreading her legs for him to dive between her thighs.

He happily nuzzled into her wet pussy, noticing that she’d removed all hair this time, even the small amount on her mound.

“Oh, fuck that’s good...” she murmured as he ate her, “...so good...”

She panted as he slid his fingers inside her, squeezing into her tight, slippery channel while he sucked on her clit. His sensory world was saturated by her, her hand on the back of his head locking him in. He loved her forcefulness, and how her hand guided him, to move where she wanted him to, to fuck her with his face exactly as she needed.

But like a guy receiving head who didn’t want to blow too early, she stopped him just before he took her to her first climax of the night, pulled him up to kiss her.

Sitting up on the edge of the bed, she sucked on his tongue, like she was feeding on the traces of her own juices on his lips and mouth, and now she reached again for his hardness. She wanted his cock as much as he wanted to give it to her, it seemed.

He held her breasts, slipped them out of the top of her corset, and this time she made no objection, moaning as he fondled her, as he crushed her hard nipples between fingers and thumbs.

“Stand up,” she ordered him, and when he did so, she tore off his shirt, then wrestled with his belt.

She was almost purring as she pulled his pants down to reveal his hard cock, then cradled it in her hands as she began to lick it, and take the tip inside her hot mouth. It wasn’t long before she slipped off the bed onto the floor, kneeling up to bob up and down on his hardness.

But she was in charge here. She wasn’t sucking on him for his benefit, or at least not primarily. She pulled on it, she beat it against her cheeks, she enjoyed the size and the shape of it, the wickedness of this strange cock.

She was enjoying her sexual freedom, Jonah could tell from experience, and it made him more certain than ever that though she was not wearing a wedding ring, she was likely married—and no doubt to the guy he had seen briefly before their two prior dates, though Jonah couldn’t really remember what the guy looked like.

“Lie down,” she said now, and Jonah hoped she was going to finally take him inside her. It had been long enough—this was their third date, and the No Strings website was really only meant for one night stands.

But she climbed on him and straddled him too far up his chest to take him inside her. She backed up, presenting him with her rear end while she took his cock in her hands again.

“Lick me,” she ordered him, “lick my pussy.”

He didn’t object, though her action on his cock bumped up the risk that he might finish too early. He grabbed her butt and pulled her to him, wedging his face between her thighs to sample her plentiful nectar. Focusing on her needs was the key to delaying his own end.

“Fuck yeah... Oh God...”

By the time she'd finished riding his face—and this time he was fully sure she'd hit orgasm—he found to his surprise that somehow she'd managed to tie his ankles to the bed with white rope. How had she been able to reach?

Jonah's heart skipped a beat. Was her husband here? Surreptitiously watching, or perhaps only listening from the en suite or one of the large built-in wardrobes? Had he slipped out while Jonah had been occupied, to bind his feet?

Jessica smiled at his noticing, as she knelt between his feet and took his cock in her hands again, looking up at his face while she licked it and placed little kisses on its tip.

“Magic, huh?” she said. “I like to tie a man down so he'll do things properly.”

She pulled away, off the bed, and now completed the job, fishing more rope from her bag to bind his wrists to the headboard. Jonah recalled Emma's warnings, her insistence that he never let another woman tie him up. But this was Jessica—if she'd wanted to kill him, she could have done it on the first date, and certainly on the second when she'd also tied him up.

He liked the feeling of giving up control to this woman, to women in general. To allow them to take what they wanted from him, to use him, to tell him exactly what they wanted him to do.

Maybe, if he was completely truthful, the slight sense of danger only added to the excitement. Like how the sense of danger had been when he watched Emma with another man, or other men—in that case, the danger that he'd lose her to someone else. Maybe he just wanted what had been promised him, the chance to fuck this gorgeous blonde-turned-brunette, and please her with his cock.

Fully secure, he lay and watched her climb back onto him, this time over his hard cock, which she held and directed to her wet pussy. He moaned at the feeling of her hot folds touching against the tip of his manhood,

and then cried out as he felt her apply the pressure, her body sinking on him, taking his pole deep inside her tight pussy.

She held his mouth shut with her hand as she fucked him, limiting his noise as he was overcome by the long-desired sensations of being inside her.

“You like being my sex slave?” she asked him.

“Yes, Miss.”

“You have a nice cock, slave. Better than my husband.”

She looked down at him as she continued bouncing up and down on his rock-hard shaft, daring him to object to her sudden confession that she was married.

“Where is he, your husband?”

The question escaped Jonah’s mouth before he could really stop it.

She flashed her eyes at him, silently chiding him for speaking out of turn. She withdrew from his cock, moved over him up the bed, to swing a leg over his face and end up kneeling over it, planting her wet pussy over his mouth once again.

Penance.

Well, there were worse acts of penance. A fresh taste of her sweet pussy. But she only enjoyed his mouth a few minutes, then she was clambering off again.

“Here,” she said, reaching for something on the floor, then stuffing it into Jonah’s mouth. Her panties. They were still damp from her arousal. “No more talking, slave.”

Then she was back on his cock, facing away from him this time, riding him reverse-cowgirl, her hand between her thighs as though holding onto the pommel of a saddle while he bucked underneath her, though he knew she must be touching her clit, rather than holding herself stable on him.

Jonah closed his eyes and enjoyed the ride, doing his utmost to hold out—presuming, that if she was in charge, she would have to give him permission to come, she would expect it.

Then he felt something at his head: someone putting a mask or a blindfold in place over his eyes. He moaned, yelled, but Jessica's balled-up underwear absorbed the sound. He was bound too tightly to object to anything.

What was going on? It couldn't be Jessica putting the blindfold in place. Had to be the husband.

The thing was good at blocking out the light. It covered his nose as well, making it difficult to get quite as much air as he'd like ideally.

"Oh God, it feels so good inside me," he heard Jessica.

He hoped that all this was was Jessica's husband come out to watch her fucking this other man, close-up. He didn't want Jonah to see him there, even though he wanted to watch his wife being unfaithful as close as he could.

Only, Jonah smelled something that made his blood run cold.

It was the blindfold, he was fairly certain. There was a slight trace of male cologne on it—and he recognized the cologne, or at least he knew that he'd smelled it recently. It took a few moments for his increasingly frightened mind to come up with where he might have smelled it.

The car—Lady Moss's vehicle when she'd taken him to her house, to view the pictures. Not her perfume, but the cologne of her driver.

Reynolds.

Jonah felt the hairs rise on the back of his neck. His cock began to wilt.

"Hey, what's the big idea, Mister? I haven't finished with you yet..." he heard Jessica shout.

Jonah tried to shut the dark possibilities out of his head—it could only be a coincidence, that Jessica's husband wore the same cologne as Lady Moss's servant. But you couldn't rely on a coincidence, he knew.

He felt Jessica pulling off him, ducking down to suck him in her mouth. She wanted to fuck him, wanted him to come in her. So she couldn't be trying to murder him, right?

Only, if she was a multiple killer, along with her husband, why did she have to play by all the rules of normal sanity? She was a psychopath. Her husband might get off on his wife's infidelity, but perhaps she got off on having not just power over men—but ultimate power over them. Life or death.

Jessica growled, and now withdrew from his cock completely. She wrenched the panties away from his mouth, and now straddled his face once again, treating him more brutally this time, punishing him for taking his erection away from her.

“Lick my fucking pussy,” she ordered him. “I don't care if you came inside me or whatever. I never told you you could.”

She ground her pussy over his mouth roughly, coating his face with her juices, rubbing her soft wet folds over his nose, his lips, his chin, holding his head firmly with two hands. Ordinarily he probably would have enjoyed it, but he wasn't keen on the desperation he could see in her eyes now she'd knocked the blindfold from its position.

“That's better... eat me... just like that...”

Jonah's mind was working harder than his tongue. If her husband was Reynolds, he would have all the access to the Network he liked—Lily might have been in all those pictures of the victims from four years ago, but Reynolds had been the one taking them. Why would he want to kill all those men? Julian Foster, Lord Moss, Nate Fielding and the others.

Reynolds didn't stand to benefit if all those men were dead.

“What?” Jessica hissed, leaning back now to grab his cock, to attempt to pump him back to hardness while she ground on his face.

Jonah realized he'd voiced his last thought while attempting to suck in oxygen.

“Your husband...” Jonah said, though she was making it nearly impossible to breathe, let alone speak. “... He works for Lady Moss, right?”

Jessica was suddenly still.

“Her valet, her butler, or whatever. Her servant—Reynolds. He’s your husband, right?” Jonah said, as the brunette relaxed her thigh-hold on his head a little.

He tried to think, but it was difficult with the blind panic now circulating his system. Jonah was getting increasingly certain that there had to be a reason why Reynolds’ wife might go on a date with him. And again, it couldn’t just be a coincidence that she’d dated him three times, and her husband just happened to be someone else he’d run into during his investigation into the Black Widow murders.

“What? What are you talking about?”

Even without a cast iron motive, Jonah felt so very certain that all these coincidences could only fit together with the theory that Reynolds, and perhaps his wife, were involved in the Hotel Killings. One or other of them was the Black Widow. Perhaps they were both killers, a team.

And here he was, having allowed them to tie him up, making him completely helpless in the face of their likely intention to kill him, too.

“Your husband is called Reynolds, right?”

Why would Jessica keep dating him, if she and Reynolds were the killers? To keep tabs on him, perhaps. To monitor his progress.

But what now? Jonah wriggled his arms, his legs, attempting to find some weakness in the binding. There was none. Should he accept his fate? Accept his death? He’d always known it might come to this. At least he had found Nate’s killer or killers. He had that satisfaction.

“You killed my brother, didn’t you?” he hissed, turning his head away from Jessica’s pussy.

She pulled herself off him. Then he heard a new voice—a male voice. Reynolds.

“We wondered how much you’d found out,” he said. “I guess that answers our questions.”

Jonah was horrified, and yet felt a massive pressure to keep calm. Panic would do him no good. Thrashing about and screaming might also prompt the killers to end his life sooner.

“Oh Jesus,” he sighed. “The butler did it, huh? You planning on killing all the men who have ever slept with your employer? And your wife happily helps you?”

Reynolds grinned, and shook his head. Jonah felt his insides freeze as the man brought his hands in front of him, and revealed the knife he was holding.

“I don’t need to answer any of your questions,” he said. “I’m not a Bond villain. I don’t need to explain myself in detail to give you time to get away.”

“No, I suppose not,” Jonah said as the man approached the bed, the steel knife gleaming in the light from the bedside lamp. “But you have to expect others will probably come to these conclusions, if I have. And I have no qualifications whatsoever as an investigator.”

Reynolds wasn’t a Bond villain—he was too ordinary-looking, too bland, despite being most likely attractive to the opposite sex. But Jonah was starting to understand why in every Bond movie, the eponymous British spy attempted to wrangle some long-winded confession out of the villain. When you were staring death in the face, you fought for every possible extra second of life that you could.

Of course, Bond villains were only too happy to explain themselves in detail, and their master plans to take over the world, because they were ultimately egomaniacs, in love with themselves and their own geniuses. Reynolds was just a servant, seemingly happy to wile away his existence in servitude to someone else—Lord Moss or Lady Moss or whomever—and remain in the shadows.

Jonah felt the dire need to keep Reynolds talking, to delay his desire to use that knife—but he couldn't appeal to the man's vanity.

"If I found you," he said, "then it's quite obvious that the others will find you, too. You know I've been working with Scotland Yard, right?"

Reynolds sighed as his wife now climbed off Jonah, and off the bed. "I don't care. I really don't care."

"Detective Inspector Mulray... she knows everything I do," Jonah babbled. Keep talking. It was his only hope. But talk about what? He took a deep breath, decided to throw some wild theories out there, see if anything rubbed Reynolds up the wrong way, got him to make a mistake.

"So you didn't do it for love," he said. "I thought you loved Lady Moss, but you don't, do you?"

"Shut up," Reynolds said.

"Maybe you did once, but that was before she married someone else and had his child... you have your own wife now, right?"

Reynolds ignored him, and turned to Jessica, who was pulling out clothes from her overnight bag—a set of completely different clothes than she had come in with. "Take your shower—and be careful."

"Of course."

"No traces."

She nodded.

Lady Moss's butler stepped back from the bed, and opened the drawer in the bedside table. Checking that Jonah hadn't left anything of note behind for the authorities.

"So what, you did all this for money?" Jonah continued to babble, but it seemed to be working. Reynolds was leaving him to talk—listening to what he knew, in case there was something he'd told the police that might lead them to the killers—while he carried out his usual checks that they were leaving no problematic evidence behind. The man was

wearing black leather gloves, Jonah noted, keeping him safe from leaving fingerprints.

“I can’t believe you guys just do all this because you like to kill people. I mean, that would be pretty sick. So I have to assume it’s about money.”

Reynolds sighed. “You really think you can rile me up, calling me greedy?”

Jonah silently conceded that since this man had already played a big part in the deaths of so many people, he might not necessarily respond to the kind of labels that would offend most people. Nevertheless, something in the man’s bearing did respond to it.

He kept talking, if only to try to distract himself from the fear of imminent death. “So the obvious money in all this is... well, I guess Lord Moss’s wealth. But how can you two possibly get your hands on it—even if Lady Moss were out of the way, which she’s not, by the way. So were you going to kill her?”

Reynolds, continuing what appeared to be a painstakingly careful examination for any trace of evidence they might be in danger of leaving behind, simply snorted at what Jonah was saying.

“But why kill all her lovers from that Breeding Party all those years ago?” Jonah asked. He thought for a moment, and the idea of a breeding party, where wives were in many cases embracing the risk of pregnancy, their husbands somehow fired up by the possibility, suddenly clicked with Lily Foster’s revelation that her husband had once undergone a paternity test—albeit one that had turned out to be negative.

“Her child,” Jonah said. “Christopher Moss was born what, three, four years ago? So his conception could have... coincided with that event, right?”

“Shut up,” Reynolds hissed as he continued to spray surfaces around the room, cleaning them up with a white rag.

Jonah found his terrified brain clutching at straws—only to find them somehow interlocking into some kind of solution to this puzzle. “So he wasn’t Julian Foster’s child, we know that. We have a paternity test that

proves that. So can we assume Lady Moss's other lovers from that night all took paternity tests? So there would be doubt as to young Christopher's parentage."

Watching Reynolds closely, he saw the man hesitate. He was probably quite tempted to stifle Jonah, to kill him right now. But he had to listen to what Jonah knew—what he might infer that the authorities would know about the killings, and how close they might be to the real killers.

The hesitation suggested to Jonah that his on-the-fly theory was close to the truth.

"So what connects the fact that all those lovers of Lady Moss had to die, and the possibility that they all took paternity tests in order to prove whether or not they fathered her child?" he asked. "So we come back to the money. If Christopher is proven not to be Lord Moss's son, then what happens to the estate after Lord Moss dies? The rest of the family starts laying claim to it, I'll bet."

"Okay," Reynolds growled, as the sound of the shower in the en suite bathroom ceased. Jessica was finished cleaning herself up. "Time for you to go, Mr Fielding. It's clear you're just brainstorming—your friends don't know anything about us."

"They know I was digging around the Moss family," Jonah said, feeling the panic beginning to slip its claws around his accelerating heart once again. "They have Julian Foster's negative paternity test—I'm sure they'll find others among the papers of the other victims."

"They won't," Reynolds said, moving to the bed, running his finger lightly over the edge of the blade to test its sharpness.

"So what happened? Julian Foster interviewed Lord Moss about his experiences—about that night, the night they shared his wife three years previously—and Julian pointed out that perhaps Christopher was conceived that night? And Lord Moss responded by having all of his wife's lovers from that night tested?"

"Not all of them," Reynolds said, leaning against the bed, as though simply needing to prove Jonah wrong, prove that his friends couldn't possibly piece together the evidence trail and arrive at him and Jessica.

“Lord Moss didn’t ask for you to be tested?”

“I didn’t give him the results of my test,” Reynolds said.

“But then you know that Christopher was yours, don’t you?” Jonah said. “That’s how you get your hands on the money. He inherits it from Lord Moss, and then what, you reveal that you’re actually his biological father?”

Reynolds shook his head, “This is nothing to do with me wanting their money.”

Jessica emerged. “It’s Christopher’s inheritance,” she said. “It’s his by right.”

Jonah looked at her, and the way she looked made him certain that she loved the young Moss boy, it wasn’t just Reynolds battling the rest of the Moss family to ensure his own biological son ended up with the loot.

“You’re the nanny,” he said to her. “Aren’t you? You love Christopher as though he was your own.”

“She doesn’t seem to care too much,” Jessica snarled. “And she probably doesn’t even care if the rest of the family get his inheritance.”

“So Lord Moss wanted to know who Christopher’s father was... so you killed him, right? Because he might have disinherited the boy, or whatever you call it?”

“He and that stupid bloody journalist had this idea fixed in their heads that they were denying some poor guy his right to know and love his child,” Reynolds said.

“So they asked everyone for a paternity test. And I’ll bet it wasn’t the fact that the tests were all negative that got them killed, right? It was because they knew by the simple fact of having a paternity test for Lord Moss that there was some doubt as to his child’s parentage.”

“The man was all over town telling people they didn’t know who Christopher’s father was,” Jessica yelled. The Moss nanny was getting dressed, and Jonah assumed that since she had already showered, it

would be Reynolds' turn to do the deed, to kill him. "All the rest of the family would have to do was bring one of them into court to testify, and they'd prove the doubts about Christopher."

"Poor Lord Moss," Jonah said, as Reynolds now loomed over him, and pointed the knife towards his throat. Could he at least make these murderers feel guilt? "I'll bet he would have legally adopted Christopher anyway. The boy would have got his inheritance."

Reynolds shook his head, "They were trying again. The Mosses. Trying for their own baby."

"Gave up his vow of chastity, huh?"

"He was giving up on Christopher—just from knowing he wasn't his."

Jonah felt the sharp point of the knife touch down on the skin of his neck.

"So what's next?" he said, feeling the horror swamping his system, his fingers and toes going ice-cold as his terrified body drew its blood into the core in some desperate final attempt to protect its core organs from whatever danger his brain was sensing. "You kill Lady Moss, so that Christopher can inherit the fortune before she lets slip to the family that she had a somewhat colorful sexual past?"

"Okay, time to go," Reynolds said.

Jonah blurted out, "I thought you loved her? Lady Moss."

Reynolds sneered again. "I did once. Before she fell for her husband. Always the danger in this kind of relationship, Mr Fielding. The wife meets someone and falls head over heels. You hear about it—see it, sometimes. Never believe it would happen to you and your own little wife-sharing arrangement."

"It must have been upsetting. You know it happened to Julian Foster, victim number one? His wife fell for my brother. It's why Julian fucked Lady Moss right in front of his wife that night."

“She doesn’t care about anyone else,” Reynolds said. “We’ll probably make everybody think she did all this, before we end her.”

“You enjoyed killing all those people?” Jonah asked him, and felt a strange relaxation now. It was happening, there was nothing he could do to stop it. Death comes to everyone eventually. Perhaps there would only be a moment or two of pain, and then nothingness. There was no pain in death itself. He had to hope that his own efforts might have pushed the investigation closer to a solution, that the police might find these guys sooner because of what he had achieved—what he had given up. But at this final moment, he found himself just plain curious: how could someone look another person in the eye and feel able to extinguish their life?

“After a while... it’s easier,” Reynolds said, almost seeming to feel like the dying man might deserve to have his final question answered. “I suppose... it does make you feel a certain kind of power, like no other...”

The butler took firm hold of the knife, and Jonah felt the pressure of that sharp point at his throat build, and then the awful searing, stinging pain of the blade piercing his flesh.

And in that moment, Jonah found his vision blurring, fizzing, then fading to black.

Eleven

Waking up, he just felt woozy, weak. Drained of energy, it was difficult for him to even lift his arms to rub his eyes.

Around him, everything was white—the bed, the walls, the floor, the door. Jesus, there really was an after-life? That was rather surprising. So he'd been a rather pathetic agnostic most of his days, probably veering more toward atheism than anything—what did that mean for him? Was this Purgatory? Was he facing Judgment, to see if he was worthy of a place in Heaven?

He cleared his throat. His mouth felt so dry, his tongue stuck to his cheeks. He tried to call for help, for anyone or any thing that might explain what was going on, what he was supposed to do here in this place. But his voice didn't seem to work properly, he only croaked.

The door opened, and a woman dressed in white entered the room, peering at him intently.

"Mr Fielding," she said, and her ordinary English accent made him relax enormously.

"Where am I?" he croaked, his voice warming up slightly as he forced it.

"You're in a private medical facility," she said, and he felt foolish not to have seen that her white coat was obviously that of a doctor, and he was quite clearly in some kind of hospital. "We were the closest to you when it happened."

"They killed me?" he said, feeling more than a little foolish.

"Well, you're not quite dead, last time I looked." The doctor held the end of her stethoscope to his bare chest, the thing icy cold against his skin. "I'm sure your colleagues will want to talk to you about exactly what happened."

“Somebody stopped them? Somebody saved me?”

The doctor looked at him, and saw that it would be cruel to keep him completely in the dark. “You were very lucky, Mr Fielding. The knife only went in a limited amount before they got you out of there.”

“Who got me out of there?”

She wrote something down on his chart, but then rather than answer his question, nodded at the door, at which he now saw a familiar face.

Emma.

“Hey!” she said quietly, calmly, though it seemed to me that her pale face was rather strained. Real concern, real fear, was something he hadn’t seen on her pretty face before.

“Hey,” he said. “They told you what happened?”

“I...” she started to fumble an answer, but he stopped her.

“Do you know who got me out of there? Who saved me? How they knew I was there—”

Emma sighed. “I was watching you,” she said.

“You were watching me?”

Jonah moved his head away from her, shook it a little as though to rid himself of the strange cotton-wool like feeling in his mind—which now he was beginning to realize was probably some kind of pain medication. As he moved his head, a dull pain emanated from his neck.

Reaching up for it, he found his neck covered by bandages.

“I’m sorry, I know you should have known the whole truth,” she said.

“We just couldn’t let you know everything—we couldn’t be sure you’d keep it to yourself.”

He looked at Emma as she drew up a chair beside his bed. Somehow she seemed a little different to him. Her hair was styled a little differently, her clothes were a little more... well, smart and sophisticated. Somehow,

she looked a little older. He felt a jolt shoot through his chest. How long had he been unconscious?

“What’s going on?” he demanded, feeling the hairs on the back of his neck rising, the cold fear beginning to circle his heart again. He tried to calm down. “You couldn’t have been watching,” he said, “I wasn’t wearing your special glasses.”

Emma looked regretful. “You were bugged anyway,” she said. “We didn’t get a great view as soon as you took your clothes off, but we could hear what was going on, at least.”

“‘We’,” he said. “You keep saying ‘we’. This was you and Mulray?”

Emma sighed. “Me... and the rest of my team.”

“Your team?”

She glanced at the door, and suddenly it dawned on Jonah that it hadn’t been Emma working for Mulray that night of the Breeding Party, supporting Mulray’s investigation. It had been the other way around.

“Who are you?” he said, feeling a little nausea now. He loved her, but suddenly he didn’t know anything about her.

“My name’s Anna Sixsmith. I work for... Her Majesty’s Government.”

Jonah opened his eyes wide a moment as the shock surged through his system. “You work for... what are we talking, secret service, MI5?”

She seemed older, because she was older. She wasn’t acting the part of a 22-year-old student called Emma any more.

“Look, you need some time to get your head around all this,” she said.

“It was all fake? All of it?”

Emma—Anna, if that was her real name—shook her head. “Not all of it, Jonah. I never lied to you about how I felt about you.”

“Just about everything else—who you were, why you wanted to see me.”

“I wanted to see you because I liked you. I like you.”

“I was just some... marque, that it? Someone you were ordered to spy on, see if I led you anywhere?”

“To begin with,” she said. “But after that first night... I liked you. I wanted to see you again. If this whole thing had ended, I would have wanted to keep seeing you.”

Jonah felt sick. His heart was aching.

“So you spied on me so you could catch them, was that it? The killers? Why would the secret service get involved in a murder investigation?”

“We were attached to the Lord Moss case. It was a national security issue before we decided to release details to the murder investigation,” she said. “We knew there was something about Lord Moss that didn’t quite add up, something about his wife. We started getting interested in what you were doing as soon as you started asking the police about Lord Moss.”

“And what, you hacked into my account on that No Strings website?” Jonah asked. “And somehow set me up to go on a date with you that first time?”

Anna Sixsmith shrugged. “It wasn’t entirely difficult to monitor you. You always used the same Internet cafe to access the site. Same computer, usually. We just saw what you were up to, and a few female agents were tasked with trying to get you out on a date.”

“And you were the lucky one, huh?” Jonah smiled.

Well, he could hardly blame her for doing her job. He could hardly be angry at her for that, though he now felt pain at the loss of Emma, the loss of Emma’s love.

“I was very lucky,” she said tenderly, and for a moment, Jonah’s heart swelled with feelings for her, seeing within her the young woman he had fallen for so heavily.

He couldn't help but feel like something of an idiot, however. She'd played him—he'd been set up, completely. Whether or not she'd enjoyed her particular mission of seduction and deception, he'd fallen for her, he'd allowed himself to be duped. So now, he felt pride pressuring him into keeping calm, avoiding any kind of display of emotion in front of her, though his insides felt as though they'd been diced, and the heat and pressure behind his eyes felt as though tears were imminent.

"So what happens now?" he said, his tone flat, neutral.

Anna sighed, "When you feel up to it, you'll receive a full debrief. It won't be too much, I swear. We just want to know if there's anything about the Network that you know, that you haven't told anyone already."

"The Network. You mean the murderers?"

She shook her head. "All that's in the hands of the police now. Separate matters, we think. The Network was the context for the murders, not the direct cause."

Jonah nodded. "But you're what, you're still investigating the Network itself?"

"I can't really say much, but it's of interest, certainly. We want to know more about it."

Well, there was the small matter of the attempts at manipulating the stock market, Jonah supposed. That probably warranted some closer scrutiny.

"Will I... will I ever see you again?" he asked, his voice suddenly small, quiet. The question, the most important of all as far as he was concerned, raising again the idea that he had been made a fool by all of this.

Anna smiled. "If you want to," she said, and he could have sworn there were signs of the girl he'd fallen for again—signs that perhaps she hadn't faked everything about the feelings she'd expressed for him during their time together. "If you can forgive me for... well, everything."

"Of course I can," he said.

She nodded. "I'd love to see you again, Jonah. More than anything. But I know how you must feel. I deceived you... to some extent."

"You had to."

"You were more than just a job for me, Jonah," she said. "Much more. But... I think you need some time for this to sink in. To really figure out what you think of me now, now you know the truth."

"I probably do," he said, and cursed himself silently for saying it, for giving her any indication he might possibly have doubts about how he felt about her.

She nodded again. "We'll give it some time. Then maybe, if you want to see me again... well... we'll see how it goes."

And that was that.

"Wait," he said as she stood, ready to leave him. "What's happened to Reynolds and his wife?"

Anna shrugged, "They'll stand trial for murder. There's enough of a confession in what they said to you before they tried to kill you. We were recording it all."

"And that's admissible evidence?"

She smiled, "We may have to fudge it a little, get you to claim you had a dictaphone going when you went to the room to meet Jessica."

"Okay," Jonah nodded, "I can do that."

"You'll see plenty more of Detective Mulray—she'll be there to support you, now it's all in the hands of the police."

"Emma—Anna," he said, stopping her as she got to the door, opened it.

"Yes?"

"Thank you," he said.

"What for?"

“For helping me find out who killed my brother,” he said, and realized this was why it was so easy to forgive Anna Sixsmith for duping him, whether she did truly feel anything for him or not. She had, at the end of the day, resolved some of the enormous pain he’d been feeling ever since Nate’s murder.

“Of course,” she said. “I’m glad I could.”

“And for saving my life,” Jonah added.

She smiled a touch regretfully, “I’m sorry we didn’t get into your room before he got at you with the knife.”

Twelve

Jonah walked up the wide marble steps, his hand skirting over a polished walnut handrail topping the cast iron balustrade. Four floors, five floors. It was certainly impressive. Was this really where Emma lived? Or Anna, or whatever her real name was.

God, he felt as though he hardly knew who she really was. He'd fallen for her, hard, and now he had to face the possibility that he'd fallen for a ghost, a figment of the imagination.

He was still desperate to see her again, but so nervous that when he did, he would be disappointed, he would be crushed, either by his own recognition that she was not Emma, she was somebody else, somebody he did not love, or by what she might say about his love, about their love, about their future.

At the top of the stairs, a glossy black door with a stylish silver handle greeted him. There was no doorbell. He fished the keys that Kaia had given him out of his pocket, shook them a couple of times as though to check they were real metal, real keys. Why had she passed on her keys to the apartment? Why not just meet him somewhere—a coffee shop, a pub, a restaurant—to talk everything over?

He put his ear up to the door, listened, but there was no sound from inside. No signs that she was in there, waiting for him to let himself in.

Heart rate picking up, he slid the Yale key into the lock, the thing gliding into the well-oiled mechanism, turning easily with a satisfying click.

The door swung open to reveal a high-ceilinged hallway, with parquet floor, minimalist yet stylish furnishings and small black-and-white framed photographs of nature scenes on the walls.

“Hello?” he called, his voice echoing slightly against all the high ceilings. “Emma? Anna? Anyone?”

He glanced back down the stairs, but there was no sign of life anywhere. He stepped inside the apartment, allowed the door to close behind him. The air smelled slightly of polish and a woman's perfume—Anna's?

He walked through to a large open-plan living room and dining room, complete with black leather couches around an expensive-looking glass and cast iron coffee table, a beautiful oak table surrounded by black leather dining chairs. On the walls, more small black-and-white prints and various large mirrors maximized the sense of space in the apartment, as though it needed that with its high ceilings and expansive floor. Smart stainless steel lamps were switched on, to give the room some cosy lighting, to soften the otherwise austere atmosphere the minimalist furnishings gave the place.

Still, no sign of life.

He ducked through a door to find a fair-sized kitchen, lavishly kitted out but appearing under-used. Again, lifeless. Back through the central reception room, he tried another door, found a bedroom. A beautiful bed, completely with freshly laundered white bedlinen, dominated an immaculate space that could have been a luxury hotel or a model for a magazine.

It all looked too tidy, too modern, too sophisticated to be Emma's apartment. Yet it gave Jonah the disturbing sense that it might be the real Emma—or Anna—and in reality she was nothing like the woman he knew.

Had she been acting, pretending to like him all this time?

Jonah heard a noise. Initially, it was so faint it almost seemed like he'd imagined it. Then, as he stood still, focused on the direction of the hallway and the apartment's front door, there it was. A quiet mumble and a giggle. The soft shuffle of feet on a marble floor. Someone was coming up the stairs.

He felt the nerves flicked inside him, hoping this was Emma, late for her appointment with him, perhaps chatting on the phone as she climbed the steps, like any young student might. Except that she wasn't a young student. She worked for the government. He had to totally reevaluate his impression of her.

And as the noise grew, and he was increasingly certain the gentle laughter was hers, he was also aware of the deeper voice, the low brogue of a man.

Had she forgotten about asking him to meet here there?

Jonah felt his stomach sink. She'd already moved on from him, she'd already found her next marque. Or maybe, she'd had him all along—this man she was with now was her real boyfriend. She'd been intending to meet Jonah to break things off with him, and he meant so little to her now, she'd completely forgotten about meeting him.

Panic shocked Jonah out of his brief daze, the jangle of keys and the rattle of the door being opened shook him into action. Run and hide. The apartment was sizable, but the furnishings so minimalist that there was hardly anywhere to run in order to hide.

Standing there in the doorway to the bedroom, he shrank back, looking this way and that. The walk-in closet, a distinct possibility. The en suite bathroom, perhaps an option if they weren't going to use it. The space under the bed was just a fraction too small for him to squeeze in. The long beige curtains might hide all but the soles of his shoes.

“You have no idea, do you?”

Standing in the middle of the bedroom, flustered, too stunned to make a proper decision on a hiding place, he heard the unmistakable sound of Emma's voice. It sent a shiver of pleasure and pain down his spine.

“Should I?”

“If you break the rules, they'll throw you out.”

Emma giggled.

She kissed him, the wet sound startling Jonah. He glanced at the walk-in closet. If Emma and her male friend intended to come into the bedroom, the darkened closet was Jonah's best hope for remaining undiscovered. Certain of which way he'd go if he needed to, as the kissing continued out in the living room, the curious Jonah edged toward the doorway.

“My husband’s going to be back soon,” Emma said, teasing her lover. Jonah caught his breath. Was she married in real life?

“I thought he was in to this kind of thing?”

The man had some kind of accent. Jonah thought Eastern European, maybe Russian, though his English was good.

“Not if I see you behind his back, he isn’t. And more than one night.”

Keeping to the shadows, Jonah veered around until he could see out of the crack between the door and its frame. Would Emma remember that the bedroom door had been closed when she’d left it? Would her friend know?

There they were. The man had close-cropped blond hair, a black designer suit, but had his back to Jonah so he couldn’t see much of his face. He wasn’t much taller than her, though she was wearing four-inch black heels. Emma wore a beige raincoat, which seemed too short for her. It rode up to reveal a scarlet skirt or dress underneath, and her legs clad in black nylon, the hem of her skirt high enough to reveal the black tops of her stockings. She looked stunning, all made up for her date.

As they kissed, the blond man unbuttoned Emma’s coat, and she smiled, the flames of excitement in her eyes.

“I’m telling you, he’s probably down there right now, parking the car,” she said, though she didn’t stop the man reaching into her coat, his hands finding the pleasing contours of her breasts.

“He’s worried I’ll steal you away?”

She smiled, enjoying the man’s persistence, the man’s obvious lust for her. “Husbands who share their wives are always worried about them being stolen away,” she said, kissing him again. “Didn’t you know that?”

“So why do they do it?”

She moaned as the man’s hands flicked open the buttons on her black shirt, and found her bare breasts underneath. “Not all men can understand it,” she said, “the fear intensifies the excitement.”

They kissed, and Jonah found himself shivering to see tongues sliding in between lips. Emma glanced toward the bedroom, briefly, and though Jonah was fairly sure she couldn't see him, he noticed her make a slight flinch, perhaps seeing the bedroom door open a few inches, not firmly shut like the other doors in the rest of the apartment. Was she remembering that she'd invited him to meet her here at this time?

Or had she purposefully invited him here at this time to witness this? Either to show him she could never belong to a single man, or to give him one last test to see if he'd want her, after knowing the reality of her profession.

The man shoved his tongue into her mouth, his hands grasping her head, then slipping down to find her behind, to squeeze her there. Emma put her hands on his chest, and moved them inside his suit jacket, to slip the thing off his shoulders.

"If you were mine, there's no way I'd let someone else touch you," he almost growled.

"But I'm not yours," Emma grinned, then sank to her knees.

She turned him slightly, as she reached for his belt, and Jonah saw that the guy was perhaps a year or two younger than him, though possibly older than Emma. Jonah now had no idea how old Emma was. Clean-cut, slender, well presented. Handsome enough. Was he a trader? Was he someone involved with the Network?

Was Emma continuing her mission to infiltrate the organization, even after the serial killers who had emerged from it were now firmly behind bars? Somehow it gave Jonah hope. That this whole encounter with the blond man was part of her work, that her husband was merely a cover story.

If she belonged to Jonah, and she had to do this kind of thing for her work, could he handle that?

She pulled down the man's black pants, revealing a pair of black boxers underneath—and the clear bulge of a rather large, erect cock. Side-on, he could see Emma beaming to reveal the beast, and he did feel that little

tickle of pleasure at the joy on her face as she peeled down the man's underwear to let his sizable manhood spring free.

Even now, when Jonah was uncertain whether she loved him, whether she wanted him, he still felt a strong love for her—and still experienced the warm feelings of compersion at seeing her happy, excited. Compersion, the opposite of jealousy, the strange altruistic force that seemed to drive husbands who shared their wives.

“Very nice,” she said, grasping that great thing with one hand, slowly pumping it.

“So what will you tell your husband, if he walks in now?” the man asked her.

“I'll tell him the truth,” she smiled, leaning forward to kiss the top of his cock, and swirl her tongue around its head. “That I met you at the party. Found you interesting.”

“Interesting, that what you call it?”

She laughed, and leaned in, taking more of his shaft in her mouth. The man tilted his head back, closed his eyes and moaned.

Emma pumped the base of his cock with her hand as she bobbed up and down on his end, stretching her lips around his considerable girth, teasing out gasps and groans with her soft, velvet mouth.

Jonah envied the man, and yet at the same time felt unbelievably turned on to wait there in the shadows and watch his beloved Emma working her magic on the man's hardness. She alternated between sucking on him and licking him, indulging in the wickedness of holding such a large, obscene package in her hands.

Did she know Jonah was watching? Hadn't that been her plan?

Surely she wouldn't do such a thing if she intended to break up with him—he might not know the real Emma, or Anna, or whatever her name was, but she couldn't be cruel, not to an innocent like him.

It all gave him hope, sufficient to turn the shock of seeing his true love in the process of screwing another man into pure unabashed delight.

The blond man ushered her upwards again, back onto her feet.

“You don’t want to finish before my husband gets home?” she grinned.

He kissed her forcefully, grabbed her behind, “Maybe I will, maybe I won’t,” he growled, and stepped around her, pushing up her coat and her bright scarlet skirt to reveal her sweet behind, and the black thong she wore.

Jonah saw her take a step toward the dining table, in the perfect position for him to see the blond guy step up, pull aside her thong, then ease the tip of his cock in between her cheeks, and glide inside her with a grunt.

Emma gasped as the man filled her.

Jonah felt his hardness throb inside his pants, and while one of his hands pressed against it, he couldn’t afford to go as far as stroking—the sensational sight of the beautiful blonde being taken like that would push him to come, and he couldn’t let that happen.

Emma leaned over the table and let the man pound into her.

“Oh yeah... oh yeah....”

It was purely a physical thing, as far as Jonah could see, so how could he object?

It was wonderful to hear her panting, gasping, moaning, her voice rising in pitch and volume the longer he took her, the further she got to her climax, so that she almost sounded like she was in pain.

But he stopped short before she hit her peak. He wasn’t done with her just yet. He pulled a chair back from the dining room table, and sat, and Emma needed precious little encouragement to straddle his lap, taking him inside her again. The man faced Jonah and the bedroom, though Emma’s body blocked him from looking that way. Jonah could see his pole plunging inside Emma as she writhed on top of him, squeezing

between her cute buttocks, his shaft glistening with her wetness each time it emerged.

In the large mirror that hung on the wall opposite, the other side of Emma and her lover, Jonah could see her breasts jiggle as she bounced on him, and her pretty face gazing over the man's shoulder as she clung to the back of the chair.

And now, she seemed to be looking over at Jonah, at the bedroom.

Did she want to know for certain he was there? Confirm that he was watching her? He got that sense. Jonah edged forward, allowed a little of the light from the living room to fall on him, so Emma could see him.

The stunning blonde lit up, her smile beaming out as her eyes connected with Jonah's. It warmed his insides no end, flames sparked inside his stomach, his cock straining against the confines of his pants to see her ecstatic response to seeing him there, watching her, adoring her, loving her despite the infidelity going on right there and then.

But Jonah couldn't risk the man finding him—couldn't face the awkwardness of such a possibility. He stepped back.

Emma slowed her pace on the man's lap, then lifted one leg off him, to climb off him and briefly crouch by his side, taking that huge beast in her mouth again. Almost like she was teasing her audience, rather than simply enjoying the feel of that great cock in her hands and between her lips once again.

When she stood once more, to re-mount him, she had removed her coat and was facing away from the man, toward Jonah. He could see her pretty smile, her pale, flushed face, the touch of perspiration in her hair. He could see her hard nipples prominent on her beautiful breasts. And he could see her slip aside her thong once again, and there was her exquisite pussy in between her stocking-clad thighs, another man's large cock protruding.

Facing away from the man, touching her clit while she rode his shaft, and looking off into the darkness where she knew Jonah waited, made it seem more and more that she was doing this expressly for his enjoyment, not that of the blond man.

And she was getting off on Jonah watching, rather than the simple pleasure of fucking the blond man.

She came, hard, collapsing momentarily back against her lover. So hot, her chest flushed along with her face, a slight gleam of perspiration on the slopes of her breasts, her wet pussy gripping that hard cock tight as the orgasm shuddered through her. Breathtaking beauty.

Then she was sitting in the chair, and he was standing over her, and Emma was directing his tip toward her bare breasts and her face, the man groaning helplessly as she coaxed his shaft, drew him on past the point of no return.

Emma had a naughty smile on her face as she pumped jets of his cream all over her chest and her neck. She looked to Jonah, in that moment, like a mischievous elf. She knew the affect she was having on Jonah, this other man marking her like that, like she was his territory.

She grinned at the man, who had to think she was simply reveling in being a naughty wife, misbehaving behind her inattentive husband's back.

They kissed, briefly, but then the man was pulling his clothes back on, smartening up while Emma sat and gently rubbed the man's come into her soft skin.

"No husband yet," the man said.

"No, I guess not," Emma replied.

"Will you tell him about me? About this?"

She nodded. He didn't seem too concerned one way or the other.

"So will I see you again?"

Emma smiled, "If you'd like to. Perhaps my husband will enjoy watching next time."

The man laughed, "Perhaps, perhaps."

Thirteen

He heard her showing the man to the door, but had to wait. The door closed, and he felt his hardness twitch at the thought that he might now be alone with Emma in the apartment. He waited a little while longer—in case the man came back for something he'd forgotten. Or in case he was still there with Emma, kissing, the front door closing again but the two lovers unable to tear themselves apart now it was time for him to leave.

After a while, he decided it was time to see what Emma was up to. He emerged, trembling slightly with lust and anxiety, and ventured out into the living room, glancing at the empty kitchen before proceeding to the hallway.

One of the doors off the hallway was open, and there she was, leaning over one of the two large white appliances, now wearing a simple white tank top and a pair of simple gray sweatpants, a vision of gorgeousness with her tousled blonde hair flowing down over her shoulders—longer than he remembered.

“Well hey, I was just about to come find you,” she said as he came up behind her.

“You leave me hanging, and your priority is laundry?” Jonah smiled as she hit the final button to start the wash cycle.

She smiled as he enveloped her in his arms. “It’s been a long day. I had to get out of those clothes.”

“You know, they invented this thing called a laundry basket? Turns out you can put your old clothes in this device and leave them until you have a better time to wash them.”

It felt strange, but he had so many heavy things he wanted to say to her—to ask her—but to hold her again, to breathe in her sweet signature coconut scent, and to see her melt into his arms, her eyes closing in

response to the pleasure she felt being held by him—somehow it didn't seem to matter so much.

"It's not really my apartment," she said. "I shouldn't leave things lying around."

"What, like grown men?"

She grinned, "Did I get it wrong? I thought you'd enjoy seeing me like that..." but her hand reached around, felt his hardness there, knew he'd enjoyed watching her.

"Who was he?" He kissed her as she turned her head to him.

"A junior official within the Russian embassy. I met him at the Breeding Party."

"Russian?"

"Quite a few Ruskies there, as it turned out. Including the head of the Russian sovereign wealth fund."

"Interesting for someone who works for... well..."

"Her Majesty's Government?" Emma turned again, smiled, a question on her lips that remained unsaid: are you horrified by what I am?

The look on her face made his insides bloom into an intense heat, recognizing that she was as anxious as he was, as fearful that this whole deception thing might mean what they'd had before could not continue. She did love him.

"The investigation continues, then," he said, trying to keep calm, dampen his growing excitement.

"It is. Since the Network continues, too."

"The Black Widow was just a tangent, then?"

"A tangent who killed a government minister, among others. So an important one."

“Was I just a tangent for you?” he asked.

“To begin with,” she said earnestly, and turned her body to him, to pull him to her as she gazed into his eyes, making sure he saw she was serious. “I was just supposed to monitor what you were up to.”

“You thought I was involved?”

“We thought you were meddling,” she laughed, “but someone had to keep tabs on you, make sure you didn’t wreck our whole operation.”

“So they picked you to seduce me.”

“Could have been any junior agent, there were quite a few trying to infiltrate that website. You chose me for a date.”

“So now what? I’m just some other guy that helped your investigation?”

“You helped considerably,” she said, kissing him. “You got us into the Network.”

“I thought that guy, that fake husband of yours, got you into the Network?”

“We wouldn’t have known about him if you hadn’t gone on that date with his wife. Wouldn’t have known who he was, that we might get him to help me into the Breeding Party for fear of exposing him.”

She kissed him long and hard, and as she did so, he realized he could detect the mild aroma of another man’s lingering scent about her, the faint trace of cologne, even the merest hint of the come he’d sprayed all over her chest.

It was deliciously wrong.

“So it was you—or your colleagues—following me in the beginning?”

“We weren’t the ones you noticed,” she gave him a mischievous grin. “That would have been the good people from the Network.”

“And that’s another thing that doesn’t add up—they followed me, they vetted me, and they apparently cleared me, and somehow believed I

actually was a trader in the City.”

Anna nodded. “Well, by that point you were our best route to actually get into the Network. At least to start with.”

“So that was you as well?”

She shrugged, “We just gave you a few... bona fide credentials.”

“Seriously?”

“As far as the world of credit agencies and background checks is concerned, you’re quite a practiced City gent,” she laughed. “You could probably go out and get a mortgage on a palace with that.”

Jonah shook his head. “Somehow I don’t think I’d keep up the repayments—even with the money Nate left me.”

Anna kissed him again, so soft, so sweet, so warm. He felt as though he could just plunge into her seduction, and never want to come up for air, simply ignore the uncertainty and doubt that the sudden revelation of her real identity provoked.

“So now what?” he said at last as they parted again, breathless. “You just move on to the next guy? And I’m just left in the dirt?”

She smiled, kissed him lightly on the lips. “We can have a private life, you know,” she said. “You can still have me if you want me.”

“Do you still want me?” he asked.

“Of course. Why d’you think they told me to step back from you while you were an active part of the investigation?”

“They told you not to see me?”

It surprised him, almost more than learning that she was working for the secret service. The strange and slightly illogical reason for her to suddenly want no physical contact with him, despite the unmistakable power of their attraction, now explained.

“I’m not completely heartless, you know,” she said, kissing him, her hands finding their way to his hard cock. “I wouldn’t just punish you for no reason like that.”

“I thought it was odd.”

“No,” she squeezed his hardness through his pants, “the real question is whether you still want me. Knowing who I really am, what I do for a living.”

“I have no idea who you really are,” he said, and kissed her mouth to show her he didn’t care who she was, as long as she was his.

“You know,” she insisted. “My details might have been a cover, but it was me with you, everything I meant, everything I felt...”

He nodded. “But I don’t even know what to call you—Emma? Anna? Something else entirely?”

“Does it matter? I can be Emma if you like.”

“What’s your real name? Or can’t you tell me?”

“Anna.”

“Well, Anna...” he kissed her, his hands sliding up underneath her tank top to find her bare breasts beneath. “...It turns out I don’t care what your name is, or what you do. Or where you live, or how much money you make, or who your friends are.”

“No?” she beamed, moaning quietly as he coaxed her hard nipples.

“I guess none of that matters if I love you.”

He heard her gasp, and her face broke out into the prettiest smile he’d ever seen, her cheeks gently flushed in surprise.

“I love you,” she said, as though she’d been building up to say it, but he’d taken away her thunder by saying it first.

He smiled, “And this is the real you saying this, not just some ploy to keep a contact functioning?”

“Of course it’s the real me,” she said. “You have to believe—”

“I believe you,” he said, kissing her delicately.

“I didn’t think you... I don’t know... I never felt like this before...” she stammered. “I’m not sure... I wouldn’t have... I shouldn’t have...”

Was she regretting setting up the evening’s voyeuristic adventure for him, now that he’d dropped the bombshell of how he felt about her? It amused Jonah, though he didn’t let that show.

“It’s okay,” he tried to reassure her.

“It could have been such a special night,” she opined. “But I just let another man fuck me in front of you.”

“What’s the problem?” Jonah grinned, and slipped his hands under the waistband of her sweatpants, to feel the soft roundness of her behind. “You were working.”

“I could have put him off to another night.”

“You wanted to know I wouldn’t be freaked out by your job.”

“Yeah, but—”

“And it was seriously hot.”

The washing machine buzzed, and briefly, Anna turned to press another button on the control panel. Jonah sank to his knees behind her, then slowly pulled down her sweatpants, revealing her bare cheeks and a lack of underwear.

“Hey—” she laughed, but didn’t stop him.

He planted kisses over her warm, velvet skin, over her behind, down her upper thighs as he removed her sweatpants completely. He parted her legs, and kissed gently up again, towards her soaking pussy. The smell of sex about her was strong, but only fueled his lust. The memory of her letting that blond man inside her, only drove Jonah’s obsession about her, his need to reclaim her, possess her.

She moaned long and low as his lips found her tender folds. He gripped her butt cheeks, tilted his head and pushed his mouth against her. She tasted spicy, tangy, a little unfamiliar. Another man's cock had been inside her, but somehow it only strengthened his hunger for her, urging him on to feast on her.

She gasped again as he licked her, her breathing becoming silky soft panting, so sexy.

Then he turned her, his strong hands manhandling her so she faced him, her butt pressing back against the white appliance.

"So I guess you can handle me being with other guys every once in a while," she said, removing her tank top now to reveal those cute breasts, those rock-hard nipples. Jonah kissed his way over her lower abdomen, one finger finding its way to the slippery groove of her sex, nudging up against her clit.

"Uh-huh," he said, kissing his way around her navel, then dropping to bury himself between her thighs, pushing his face onto her mound, breathing in her spice as he slipped his wet tongue out and into her drenched pussy.

"Oh God..." she sighed, and he felt her legs weaken a little, her hand on his head having to help prop her up.

He held her firm in his hands, stood, lifted her up off the ground. She let out a little squeak as he lifted her onto the washing machine. He kissed her mouth, and she didn't flinch from tasting herself on his lips.

Then he knelt, parted her thighs further, pulled her onto the edge of the machine so her puffy red flower was right there for him to devour.

"So how's this going to work?" she asked him in between sighs and gasps as he tongued her wet pussy lips.

"Nobody ever tell you about the birds and the bees?" he joked.

She rolled her eyes, but smiled. "I mean, we go on seeing each other, right? Maybe some day find a place to move in together?"

He sucked on her tender folds, said: “Get a dog, have kids, that kind of thing? Relax... we can go as slow or as fast as you want.”

He saw in her face that his words reassured her. Was she the type who would want kids some day? How would that work if she chose to continue her career in the secret service?

“It’s just...” she said “...I won’t be able to talk to you. About my work.”

“About the guys you sleep with?” he interpreted.

She nodded. “Even tonight, I was... stretching the rules.”

He teased apart her pussy with his hands, then sank onto her, pushing the tip of his tongue as deep into her as he could, before coming up for air.

“I guess I’ll have to... imagine your hot little encounters then,” he said between licks. “If you’re away for the night... I’ll have to assume... you’re being wicked with someone else.”

“And you’d be okay with that?”

He nipped one of her pussy lips, making her squeal and laugh. “Maybe you could drop me little hints,” he said. “You know, leave me a little clue here and there, enough so I was sure you were a naughty girl, but not enough to get you locked in the Tower of London.”

“I could do that,” she stroked his hair as he lapped up her juices, sighed and tilted her head back, adding: “fuck that feels good...”

He loved making her writhe with his mouth, consuming her wickedness, saturating his senses with her unfaithful sex. Would he really be able to handle a lifetime loving a spy, knowing she might at any time be called in to use everything at her disposal to help further a mission—including her body—but forever keep any infidelity secret from him?

Reaching up to cup and fondle her breasts as he ate her, adoring the blissful expression on her face as he took her to heaven, he felt certain he could adapt, do whatever it took to keep her.

“Oh my God... Holy shit...”

She tousled his hair ferociously as she reached a panting, gasping, shuddering climax over him, the vibrations of the appliance underneath her helping produce a colossal orgasm.

“You know,” she said, once she was able to pull herself up from the machine, “my boss suggested recruiting you.”

“Recruiting me?”

“We could still use you in this mission.”

She grabbed his hand, dragged him out of the laundry room, through the living room.

“I’m not exactly James Bond,” he said, as she pulled him on into the bedroom, then started pulling off his clothes.

“Not necessarily as a field agent,” Anna said, “although we could use your services if there were any wives requiring your... talents.”

She kissed him, slipping her tongue into his mouth, her hands finding his hard cock ready and waiting for her.

“I don’t really have any qualifications relevant to your... well, to the Service,” he protested. “I was going to study sociology, criminology—work myself up to something.”

“The Service doesn’t need people with letters after their name. Experience, insight, intelligence.”

Anna lay back on the bed, pulling Jonah with her. He felt his heart pounding, thinking this was the moment he’d been waiting for for so long. She was so beautiful, gorgeous with her sexual freedom, her need to push boundaries, her voracious libido. He put the tip of his cock against the burning soft flesh of her sex, stroked her with it, then slipped inside.

Inside a woman who he’d watched take four men at once. Inside a woman who would seduce other women as readily as other men. Inside a woman as the second man to do so within the hour.

“You’re so hard...” she gasped, and she was right. The sight of his beloved being taken by someone else incensed him to want to take her back, his body pumping out every possible ounce of hormone to ensure the triumph of his genes over the guy before.

She felt incredible, moaning quietly as he filled her.

“Slow,” she pleaded.

“A little tender?”

She nodded.

He moved a little more gradually inside her, but she was so wet that once she was accustomed to his being there, she no longer noticed or cared about any soreness.

She groaned and blasphemed as he thrust into her, and before long she was begging for him to fuck her, fuck her hard.

When he pulled back a moment, letting things die down so he didn’t come too soon, she said: “If I recruited you... if you joined up... I’d be able to tell you about... you know...”

“About the men you fuck for the good of the mission?” he chuckled.

“Something like that.”

He turned her over, urging her onto all fours, and briefly slipped his hot mouth over her soaking pussy lips before lining up to take her again.

“You think you’ll want to do that?” she asked between gasps as he entered her once more.

“Maybe.”

“I’d come home at the end of the day... and at the very least I could tell you about the guys I had to flirt with.”

“Uh-huh.”

“The guys who want me, the guys who take me out on dates because they think I’m just some dizzy blonde... the guys who tell me all their secrets... when they take me home to fuck...”

“Right.”

“And the girls, too. You know, they’ve appointed Mulray as our official liaison in Scotland Yard for this case?”

Jonah slammed into her, feeling a powerful compulsion to take her, make her his, own her. He grabbed her hips as he thrust inside her, reclaiming her from all the men he’d seen her with. She was so sexy, so smoking hot, this pretty blonde who was his and yet too much for him alone.

“Oh... yeah... fuck...” she gasped, cried with each impact.

But then they were kissing again, lying on their sides, Anna turning to him as he continued sliding his hardness inside her, more tenderly, loving. It was more than just a physical thing for them, more than just the enjoyment of two attractive people coming together to scratch an itch.

They teased each other, they wrestled, they laughed together, and underneath the surface of who this woman was, she was to Jonah the same person she’d always been. And when at last he took her over the edge of her monumental climax, holding her tight as she shuddered underneath him, and his hardness pulsated as he came deep within her, the connection between them seemed stronger than ever.



Afterward, he lay exhausted next to her, his body still pulsating with the memory of making love to such an incredibly beautiful woman, his senses still jangling with the lingering traces of her arousal and his mind whirling with images of naked perfection, of his cock thrusting inside her.

Eventually, he left her sleeping to duck out and use the facilities in the perfectly presented en suite bathroom.

He felt somehow dazed, and as he finished up, almost a touch melancholic—as through he was in a dream with the feeling he was about to wake up. It was uncertainty he felt, as he might after a wonderful first date with someone really special—he knew he wanted her, but had those nagging doubts that she might not feel the same way about him.

Was Anna on the level about how she felt about him? About wanting to be with him long-term?

He flushed, and set about washing his hands, only to be startled by the door opening, for a near-naked Anna to slip inside the bathroom. She was wearing a black bra and matching panties now, though nothing else.

“Hey,” she whispered, and leaned up to him to kiss his mouth as he turned to her.

“What’s up?”

“Oh, nothing. Suddenly got the fear you sneaked out on me.”

“You know I’d never do that.”

Anna smiled, “I guess you haven’t changed at all, have you? It’s just me. I’m not quite the person you thought I was.”

He could hardly blame her for duping him. It was her job. But somehow he’d transcended her job—would there be others who would do likewise?

He’d have to trust her, that she wanted him like he wanted her.

“I’ll make it worth your while, I promise,” she smiled, and her hands seemed naturally drawn to his manhood, which was thickening by the second as she touched it, despite its recent overuse.

“So this was nice...” he said, feeling his stomach lurching towards his feet as he knew in his heart that he had to air his doubts, his fears,

knowing it might only accelerate the break-up of this fun little thing they had going.

“Wasn’t it?” she beamed, starting to pump his cock in her fist.

“Only... if I’m honest... it’s a little confusing.”

“Confusing?”

He sighed. “I guess... it makes me wonder... well, where we stand. So to speak.”

“Well, you’re standing right here...” Anna joked, and pulled the tip of his rigid cock down to lodge it between her hot thighs, up against the wet warmth of her cotton-clad sex.

“But all this... well, is it just a bit of fun?”

Anna looked up at him and smiled, “It is fun, isn’t it?”

“Of course, but—”

“But you’re wondering if we get to be together now, right? Long-term?”

Jonah nodded.

She smiled again, more broadly than ever, “I’m yours, silly, didn’t you know that? It’s why I had to stop sleeping with you while you were still technically a person of interest in our investigation.”

He nodded. “And you’re Kaia’s as well?” he asked, though he didn’t want to make it sound as though he was jealous, as though he couldn’t accept Anna being genuinely polyamorous, if that was her choice.

She giggled, “She’s just a fuck buddy. One that I work with, so I do have to be at least a little careful, but it’s not the same.”

She kissed him, and suddenly her face was all serious, and they weren’t kidding around. “I do love you, you know.”

Jonah’s heart leapt. Jesus, it felt like fireworks were going off inside his chest. She kissed him again, long, tender, passionate, filling his heart

with brightness, his lungs with her sweet coconut scent.

“I love you, too,” he said breathlessly when she eventually broke off from their kiss. “I think I did from the start.”

She grinned, “I want to ask you something. It might not seem... conventional.”

He laughed, “Is there anything conventional about us as a couple?”

“When I talked to my handler about all this... and... you know, about recruiting you to help figure out this whole Network thing...”

“Yes?”

“She suggested... well, hinted, more like...”

“What?”

Anna leaned back a little, and now dipped a hand in between her cleavage. Fishing for something in her bra.

It glinted in the halogen lights glaring down from the bathroom ceiling as she presented it to him.

A ring. Complete with a princess-cut diamond.

“Will you marry me, Jonah?” she asked, and it seemed for a moment like more of her carefree humor—except that her face was straight, serious again.

“Aren’t I supposed to be the one to ask you?” he said, his mouth just working on autopilot while his stunned brain attempted to catch up with what was going on.

“You can if you want,” she smiled. “But this is the twenty-first century, you know.”

“You bought me a diamond ring?”

She laughed, “That would be a win for feminism, right? But if you like, I can wear it for the both of us. You know, a girl does like a diamond on

her finger...”

Jonah nodded, but still felt an ounce of uncertainty. “And this would be... for the benefit of the investigation, right?”

Anna rolled her eyes, then kissed him. “This would be for the benefit of us, silly. For always. It just might be nice during the investigation, when you’re aware I’m out there... with other guys... well, to know I have a ring on my finger. Your ring.”

“Even when you take it off to go undercover?”

She grinned, and squeezed his cock between her thighs. “I don’t have to while we’re tackling the Network, do I? As far as they’re concerned, I’m just a naughty wife, and you’re my loving husband enjoying my wicked infidelities as I get to know the power behind the organization.”

Jonah nodded, and felt a little tickle of desire and jealousy within his chest. “And the thing is, I really will be your loving husband, enjoying your wicked infidelities, won’t I?” he smiled, feeling his manhood throbbing at the thought of Anna being his very own insatiable, hot wife, enjoying the debauchery of other mens’ desires before returning to him for him to reclaim.

“I have read you right, haven’t I?” she said, suddenly concerned. “That is what you’d like?”

He smiled, “I’d like nothing more.”

He turned her, and stepped behind her as she leaned over the sink. Then he slipped the little black cotton panties down over her cute behind so that they dropped to the tiled floor, and in one easy motion, thrust his hard cock deep inside her well-oiled pussy.

“Oh God...” she cried out, as they both locked eyes via the bathroom mirror. “You get so hard after I’ve had another man’s cock inside me...”

“I guess I need to reward you for coming back to me,” he smiled.

“Mmm... I like rewards...”

“So when’s your next date?” Jonah asked, feeling himself getting so close again, as he gazed at his beautiful fiancée in the mirror.

“He’s expecting to see me tomorrow night, actually,” she said.

“Okay.”

“He’s promised to introduce me to the Russian Ambassador’s son.”

“Over dinner?”

“And probably a bed.”

And at the thought of his soon-to-be wife taking two other men at once pushed Jonah to an earth-trembling climax, his hardness pulsating as he pumped his hot seed deep inside her.

A romantic scene featuring a couple in an intimate embrace on a dark couch. The man is shirtless, and the woman is wearing a light-colored t-shirt and white shorts. In the foreground, two glasses of red wine are visible on a dark surface. The text "more hot wives exploring other men..." is overlaid in a white serif font.

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